

FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN
(working title)



Written by

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Inspired by the novel
The Loves of Judith by
Meir Shalev

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Colorado Film
Vivo Film

SUPER: 1928 BRITISH MANDATE OF PALESTINE

Uncultivated land covered with rocks. A pick hacks into the ground, cracking it open, over and over, moving away the stones.

CUT TO:

Hands place a plant in the hole dug out in the terrain, now cleared of rocks.

CUT TO:

The soundtrack, timeless and epic, begins on aerial shot of barren, sun-scorched landscape.

White tents pitched in a row. A group of about thirty young people are unloading wooden planks and piles of building materials from a van, forming a human chain.

A new settlement is coming into being.

FADE TO:

The women wear shorts and work boots, their shirt sleeves rolled up, hair tousled in the wind. The men in tank tops and Lenin workers' caps. This youth is modern and egalitarian. The pioneer atmosphere thrums with energy, cheer, and enthusiasm. The sun at its highest sculpts their radiant faces, muscles and smiles.

They hoist a wooden framework. It is the skeleton of a water tower they are building.

FADE TO:

The shadows have stretched. The light is warm, soft. Their rhythm is slower, more relaxed. A few are sitting.

Straddling the top of the scaffolding that surrounds the tower, **YAAKOV SCHEINFELD** (30), handsome, dark curly hair, gazes at a flock of cranes flying off into the horizon.

A robust man below calls out at him, teasing. **GLOBERMAN** (35), sly with dark, penetrating eyes, is intriguing, though not handsome. He wears a fedora at a rakish angle.

GLOBERMAN

Hey, Yaakov Scheinfeld! Make sure
you whistle when you see land!

A few of the others burst out laughing. Yaakov looks down, half-smiling.

YAAKOV

You have no idea what you're
missing, Globerman when you only
peer down at what is under your
nose...

Right then, two women walk past Globerman carrying buckets of malt. One is RIVKA (25), strikingly beautiful. Wearing a kerchief over her hair, shorts, and a knotted blouse, she is Globerman undresses her with his eyes as he fixes his hat.

GLOBERMAN

(grinning, joking)

Under my nose?... I see the promised
land.

Rivka glares at Globerman. Then she smiles at Yaakov, giving him a smile, as her friend elbows her. Yaakov smiles back and then goes back to enjoying the view of the landscape.

Another man (MOSHE RABINOVICH, 30) smiles as he hoists heavy planks up the scaffolding. Not handsome, but he has broad-shoulders, a singular intensity in his gaze and a sincere smile. He turns towards a pregnant woman (TONYA, 30), energetic and sturdy, pushing a cart full of bricks with her child (ODED, 2) in tow.

MOSHE

Tonya, you've been working since
this morning...

TONYA

(jokingly)

You too, Moshe...

Moshe smiles and grabs another wooden plank.

At the edge of the camp, a short, skinny man (PAPISH 45) plants a sign in the ground: "BEIT CALEB, population: 65." The sinking sun sets the sky ablaze, and the sign casts a long shadow on the ground.

The music ends as the scene closes...

2

INT. NURSING HOME - 1978 - DAY

2

SUPER: 1978 RHODE ISLAND, USA

In the back of a tidy garden, out of focus, a woman of 45 (ESTHER HORWITZ) is smoking, her back toward us. Slim, a bit hunched, hugging herself, hair casually pulled back, she is in a dark mood.

A hand knocks on the image, revealing that this view has been through a window. The woman turns with a start, showing her beautiful, intense, but exhausted gaze.

She snuffs out the cigarette, and opens the sliding glass door on the terrace and comes into a dimly-lit room. A NURSE draws near her, speaking in a whisper.

NURSE

I'm sorry, Mrs Horwitz... visiting hours are over.

Esther nods. The nurse leaves. Esther remains next to the sliding glass door, not moving. In the middle of the room, an I.V. drips into a person somewhere hidden in the sheets of the only bed in the hospice room.

2 bis INT. WAITING ROOM/NURSING HOME. GIORNO 1978

2 bis

A small waiting room with a glass wall overlooking the corridor. From the outside we see Esther sitting on a chair with her head bowed.

From the inside, through the glass wall we see a woman approaching (**MAYA**, 40) dressed in a casual way, not particularly well-groomed, but with nice features. She looks tired. She is holding two paper glasses, and gestures Esther to open the door for her. Esther stands up and opens the door. The other woman hands her one of the glasses.

MAYA

Here, you need it.

ESTHER

Thanks.

Maya sits down, Esther remains standing, sipping her coffee. She makes a face.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Is there milk in this?

Maya replies, hesitant.

MAYA

Oh, yeah... did you want it without?

Esther reassures her and sits down.

ESTHER

Yeah... no. Don't worry about it, this is fine.

Maya stands up.

MAYA

I'll go grab you a black coffee, if you want.

ESTHER

I said it's fine, Maya. Really.

Maya sits down again and sighs. She looks at her watch.

MAYA

Sam's on his way. I hope he gets
here in time to see Mom again,
say goodbye...

Her voice breaks. Esther looks at her without being able to do or say anything, as if seeing her pain embarrassed her. She stands up again and begins to pace the room.

Maya clears her voice.

MAYA (CONT'D)

Are you planning to stick around
for a few days? After...

Esther avoids to make eye contact, she is elusive. She walks back and forth like a caged animal.

ESTHER

Well, no, I don't think so. I
need to get back to San
Francisco. I have my job and
then... you know, my stuff...

Maya shakes her head and interrupts her, sarcastic.

MAYA

Your stuff, right. Well, I can't
say I'm surprised.

Esther stops, she looks up and sighs, then looks at her pleadingly.

ESTHER

Oh, please, Maya.

Maya takes on a fake condescending tone.

MAYA

Let it go, Esther, never mind.
Forget it.

Maya stops talking and keeps shaking her head. Then she goes on talking to herself but making sure she can be heard.

MAYA (CONT'D)

Pretty soon my kids will be grown
up and you don't even know them.

Hurt, Esther replies in a soft voice.

ESTHER

Come on, Maya, spare me the
lecture, at least for today.

Maya does not listen and keeps going with her passive-aggressive attitude.

MAYA

Oh, okay. Let me know when you
feel like talking..

Esther stiffens.

ESTHER

What, you call this "talking"?
I'm going for a cigarette.

She grabs her bag on a chair and turns to leave when Maya goes in for the kill, as if giving voice to her thoughts.

MAYA

If you knew how many times Mom
tried to get in touch with you..
She didn't recognise anyone
anymore, but... "Etty... Etty..."
(bitter)
She could go on like that for
hours.

Esther stops in front of the door and without turning around, looking down. She sighs deeply.

ESTHER

I know, Maya, I live three
thousand miles from here. You
wanna lay a guilt trip on me? I
did everything I could to--

Maya raises her voice, poisonous.

MAYA

Everything you could? Really? All
you did was make her worry about
you and all your shit! At least
when she lost her memory, she
forgot about your fuck-ups--

Esther turns around at once with an upset expression. She replies raising her voice.

ESTHER

What did you say? Really?
(exhausted)
And you still wonder why I don't
want to hang out with you and
your family??

MAYA

It's the truth! You never, never...

Esther covers her ears.

ESTHER

I hate it when you say never!

They are interrupted by someone opening the door. They spin around. It is the nurse, looking serious and kind. She is embarrassed.

NURSE

Come, it's time.

They follow the nurse. The door closes again and the room remains empty and silent, Esther's coffee, untouched on the table.

3	OMISSIS	3
4	OMISSIS	4
5	INT. JOSH COHEN'S HOUSE. DAY	5

The door of an apartment seen from the inside, the doorbell rings. Someone opens the door, Esther appears with a hint of a smile, melancholic.

ESTHER (V.O.)

(jokingly)

I hope you have a good reason for making me come here on a Saturday morning.

An elegant and sturdy sixty-year-old (**JOSH COHEN, 55**) wearing a wool cardigan and a shirt, lets her in. They hug. He puts a hand on her shoulder but we do not hear what they say.

JOSH (V.O.)

I asked you to come over on a Saturday morning because you're leaving today, not because I'm a sadist... how are you?

CUT TO:

Esther and Josh are sitting on a couch in an elegant living room. In front of them on the table, two cups of hot tea. Josh has a serious and focused expression. Esther is a little nervous.

ESTHER

Fine.

(straight to the point)

So, what's the big mystery?

Josh hands her a **thin envelope sealed with wax**. On the top in handwriting we read: "For Esther".

JOSH

This is for you.

Esther weighs it in her hands, perplexed.

She breaks the seal and opens it. She takes out a **letter**. She sits down. As she reads it, the furrow on her brow grows deeper and deeper.

ESTHER

What does this mean... do you know
what is this about?

JOSH

Yes. It means what it says, nothing
more nothing less.

(beat)

Your mother entrusted me with this
letter ten years ago, when your
father died... She was just starting
to lose her memory, and she wanted
to put it down in black and white
before it was too late.

Esther is about to say something, but he beats her to it.

COHEN

No, your brother and sister know
nothing. It only concerns you, and
you're the only one who should deal
with it. That's what Leah wanted.

Esther reads through the letter again. Then she shakes her head. She pulls two objects out from the envelope: a torn **photograph** and a **small pendant of a flower with a date engraved on it: 4th of October 1932**.

ESTHER

What's this about, Josh?... Who are
these people?

The lawyer replies politely yet firmly.

JOSH

I only know what's written there...
and frankly, even if I knew more,
I'd think twice before telling you
anything... I mean...

(chuckling)

(MORE)

JOSH (CONT'D)

Leah was a lovely woman, but... let me tell you... when she got something into her head...

Esther gives a small smile tinged with melancholy. The man points at the two objects she is holding.

JOSH (CONT'D)

Those tell you anything?

Esther looks at the pendant and shakes her head. Her gaze lingers on the photograph. It shows a handsome 30-year-old man (**SHIMON HORWITZ**) in shirtsleeves and suspenders, a smile in his eyes, holding a newborn. In the background, a water tower with an ear of wheat drawn on the cylindrical tower.

ESTHER

(staring at it, perplexed)
I've never seen myself so small.
(bitter)
Papa's so young here... He almost looks gentle...
(realizing)
We're still in Israel here... I didn't think there were any photos of us from that time...

Esther looks up from the photo and stares at Josh. Her eyes tear up, but her gaze is angry.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Why didn't they ever show it to me?
I don't understand.

She lights a cigarette, stands up and goes to pour herself a glass of scotch from a small table with several bottles. She takes a sip. Her tone gets more annoyed and on edge.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

What do I know about Israel and everything else? Why didn't she tell me about it when she could've, instead of writing me... this... this.. whatever it is...

Josh waits for her to calm down, then resumes in a calm tone.

JOSH

I can give you a hand. I know a lawyer in Jerusalem... a friend of mine from WW2. He can start doing some of the research and...

ESTHER

(still lost in thought)
What's the point of asking me to do something without even explaining why?

JOSH

Leah must have had her reasons, if--

Esther interrupts him abruptly.

ESTHER

If she had good reasons, she
could've told me!

(gesturing)

Can't anything in my life ever just
be over and done with?

Esther turns, sighs heavily. She takes a few steps to leave
then turns to give the envelope back to Josh.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Not for me. I'm done. I want
nothing more to do with this
family.

Josh does not take the envelope back.

JOSH

That's yours. I did my part.

She just stays there, holding the envelope in one hand and
the glass in the other.

A rustle of leaves blowing in the wind..

5 bis EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY

5 bis

SUPER: BEIT CALEB, 1935

The leaves of a eucalyptus tree sway in the wind. The tree is
in the middle of a farmyard glowing in the morning sunlight.
The farmhouse is comprised of a small white building and a
stable, simple and squat. Similar houses surround it. In the
center of the houses is the finished water tower.

Tonia is hanging laundry on a line at the edge of the
farmhouse. The sun hits the white of the linens and
reflects on her face. A little girl (**NAOMI**, 7 years old)
is running in zigzags through the linens, giggling, making
her mother laugh.

Behind Tonia, Moshe and ODED (9) are carrying some hay.
Moshe and Tonia exchange a knowing and pleased look.

CUT TO:

The farmyard is bathed in the evening light. Tonia is sitting
outside the house mending some socks. Moshe comes out with
two cups of steaming tea and hands one to the woman. He sits
beside her.

6

INT. MOSHE'S HOUSE/STABLE - DAY

6

Inside the small stable that shelters a few cows, Globerman studies the hooves, mouth, and ears of newborn calf. Moshe's entire family is standing there, awaiting a response.

Moshe looks the merchant over, skeptical. The children watch the scene, curious.

MOSHE

That won't work with me, Globerman...
you know very well, it's a stud.
It's worth at least 10.

Globerman is still hunched over the calf. He tilts his hat back a bit, scratching his head.

GLOBERMAN

(chuckling)
Three weeks, give or take, and this
calf ends up on my plate. Six
pounds... no more.

Naomi's eyes widen.

NAOMI

No, no, Mom, don't sell him, let's
keep him!

Tonya strokes her daughter's hair.

TONYA

It's all theatrics. That calf is a
breeder. That's the truth, just
like you're my Noimele. It's
perfect.

Naomi, calmed, squints.

NAOMI

What's theatrics?

MOSHE

What Globerman does to lower the
price, Naomi. It's pretend, a show.
In fact, I won't give it to him for
less than nine.

GLOBERMAN

The only theatrics here is what
you're doing to rob an honest
businessman... seven.

They seem to be enjoying this.

MOSHE

Eight-fifty.

GLOBERMAN

Seven-fifty. But don't let it get around.

MOSHE

Eight. My last offer.

Naomi and Oded are entranced by the bargaining, holding their breath, tense. Globerman gives a long sigh.

GLOBERMAN

Benemunes parnuse?

MOSHE

Benemunes parnuse.

Globerman takes out his wallet, scratching his forehead. Naomi watches her father, not understanding.

NAOMI

What's Bemememe?

TONYA

Benemunes parnuse is fair profit, the just value, where no one loses out. If someone proposes Benemunes, you have to stop bargaining right there and then.

GLOBERMAN

After that, no more lying and you close the deal. That's it.

9-YEAR-OLD ODED

(to Globerman)

Well, why didn't you just say that?

The merchant holds out the money to Moshe and then turns to Oded and whispers, chuckling.

GLOBERMAN

That's my favourite part of the trade.

Oded listens to him, fascinated. As Moshe counts the money, Tonya looks outside the door. Then she turns to her husband, worried.

TONYA

Let's go to the market now. Hurry, the sky is turning grey.

Yaakov walks out of a house very similar to Moshe and Tonya's home. He reaches a wooden shed next to the house. Hens and fowl roam around it.

Yaakov goes into the shed and greets the chicks in the wire cage with terms of endearment. He goes over to a rudimentary hatchery with eggs.

YAAKOV

Hello there, little ones...

RIVKA (O.S.)

(harsh)

We could try too... to have our own...

Yaakov jumps with a start and turns. Rivka is at the door with a basket of oranges and a mocking expression.

YAAKOV

Rivka, you frightened me...

She looks at him as she walks away.

RIVKA

(allusive)

I won't bite you, Yaakov.

Yaakov ignores her and goes back to looking after the chicks.

8

EXT. COUNTRYSIDE - TORRENT - 1935 - DAY

8

Under the dark sky, a mule pulls Moshe and Tonya's cart across the countryside. On the flatbed, numerous crates filled with limes.

The cart approaches a small downward slope that cuts through the road: **a surging torrent of water runs on the bottom of the ford.** Moshe looks at Tonya, concerned.

MOSHE

Should we go back?

TONYA

(reassuring)

Go ahead.

Moshe grabs tight onto the mule's reins as he starts descending the ford.

Everything happens in a matter of seconds. The mule's hoofs slip on the muddy bank pulling down the cart and overturning it. The mule gets bogged down into the water, more than thirty centimeters deep.

Trapped under the flatbed, Moshe screams in pain.

MOSHE

Oh God, my leg!

He looks around, searching for Tonya. He spots her head, just barely above the muddy water. The rest of her body is pinned down under the cart. **Tonya's eyes fill with terror.**

TONYA
(a wisp of voice)
Moshe... my Moshe...

Moshe uses all his strength to lift the cart.

MOSHE
Crawl out, Tonya!!!

The rising water is about to reach her mouth. Tonya struggles with all her might, but her body is trapped.

Moshe tries again. And again. But it is no use.

The rushing torrent sucks Tonya under. Distraught, Moshe calls for her... over and over again...

MOSHE (CONT'D)
Tonya!!! Tonya!!!

9 INT. BAR - 1978 - EVENING

9

Moshe's cry fades on Esther's close up shot.

The woman is sitting at the bar. The place is empty. She swirls her drink, clinking the ice around.

BARTENDER (O.S.)
Welcome back. Were you away on business?

ESTHER
No, I... Yeah, yeah. A business trip.

She raises her glass and watches it swirl. Then she looks down and gives a naughty smile.

A **BEARDED MAN** of around 50 is watching her. He's seated near by. She raises the glass in his direction suggestively.

10 INT. ESTHER'S HOME - BEDROOM - 1978 - NIGHT

10

The detail of a large print portraying a woman's hand and that of a child holding a pomegranate, towers over the bed where Esther and the man from the bar are having sex, losing themselves in the excitement.

11 INT. ESTHER'S HOME - BEDROOM - 1978 - DAWN

11

Close-up shot of Esther who is waking up. Still hangover she massages her temples in the room furnished in modern style.

She turns around and gives a start. She covers her mouth not to scream: the man of the night before is sleeping beside her with his mouth open.

Esther mouths a curse silently.

The man is starting to wake up. Esther turns on her side pretending to be asleep.

The man turns towards her stretching to move closer to her.

BEARDED MAN
Hey... you asleep?

No answer.

BEARDED MAN (CONT'D)
I'm going. That was nice...

The man gives her a light kiss on the cheek and gets dressed.

Not moving, Esther, opens her eyes, feeling sorry.

12 MONTAGE: E/I. MOSHE'S HOUSE ESTHER'S HOUSE - 1935 - 12
DAY/NIGHT

1935. Looking grim, with a cast up to his hip, Moshe drags himself into the stable to milk the cows. The two children try to lend a hand, but the whole situation is dire. Exhausted, Moshe throws his crutches on the ground.

DISSOLVE TO:

1978. Esther opens the half-empty fridge, with several bottles of vodka and wine inside. She grabs a bottle of milk and swallows two pills drinking directly from the bottle.

DISSOLVE TO:

1935. It's sunset. Moshe submerges himself in the trough in the farmyard. Slowly, the plaster cast starts to dissolve, the water turning milky.

DISSOLVE TO:

1978. The sound of a shower and the detail of a note left on the bedside table with a phone number: "My name is Rick by the way...". Esther crumples it.

DISSOLVE TO:

1935. In the evening at dinner, still limping, Moshe places a hunk of cheese and a potato on his children's plates. Oded glowers at him.

Moshe is ashamed. He sighs, glancing at a photograph of Tonya hanging on the wall.

DISSOLVE TO:

1978. Dressed in her hostess uniform, with her hair pulled back in a chignon, Esther is putting some make-up on, but her eyes are wet and a tear streams down her cheek marking the foundation on her skin.

13 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1935 - NIGHT 13

Late in the evening, Moshe, limping but determined, crosses Yaakov's farmyard. He reaches the door and knocks.

Yaakov opens the door, surprised to see Moshe who does not come in. Rivka comes over.

YAAKOV

... Moshe, what...

Moshe doesn't let him finish. Looking down, he speaks, clear and direct, to both of them.

MOSHE

I need... help for my children. I'll pay what's fair. It would be making them dinner for a while, with all the work I've got to do, I can't...

Rivka interrupts to relieve him of the embarrassing situation. Concrete, reassuring, but with a tinge of regret.

RIVKA

Moshe, I don't have children and your children no longer have a mother. You don't owe us a thing.

Relieved, Moshe thanks her with a nod of his head.

14 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY 14

Moshe is doing the laundry in a tub, but rather than hang it, he tosses it haphazardly on the line, still soaking wet.

GLOBERMAN (O.S.)

How long do you think you can keep this up, Rabinovich?

Moshe turns to the merchant but does not answer. Globerman is staring at him, with his foot resting on the fence.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

There's a woman in my brother's settlement.

(MORE)

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

Still young, alone, a good woman,
looking for work. You could take
her on to help.

Proud, Moshe dismisses him without even turning around.

MOSHE

Rivka brings us dinner every
evening. We don't need anything
else. I'm managing, Globerman.

GLOBERMAN

You can't do it all by yourself,
Moshe. A mother could, but not a
father... not alone.

Moshe doesn't answer. With his back to Globerman, he slaps
the soaking laundry, sending the hens clucking every which
way.

14 bis INT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD 1935 - EVENING

14 bis

Moshe comes home exhausted, it is almost dark outside. He
puts some wood in the stove.

Concerned, he turns towards the sobbing coming from the next
room. He approaches, the door is open.

He looks inside and sees Naomi curled up on the floor in a
corner of the room with her back to us, sobbing.

The man is heartbroken but he stays on the threshold.

15 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935- DAWN

15

Moshe is loading the milk churns when Oded comes out of the
house, ashamed.

ODED

... I'm sorry... it happened again...

Moshe notices the boy's night clothes are wet.

Exasperated, Moshe starts cursing, so much that his neighbor
Papish stops at his fence, alarmed, staring at him.

MOSHE

(yelling)

Why?!? Are you doing this on
purpose, Oded?!?

Oded sobs into his hands. **Moshe reaches the boy, his
impatience exploding, and slaps him** without taking into
account his strength. The boy falls to the ground.

Moshe's world seems to crumble around him. He brings his hands to his head, pale white, in despair, then crouches over his son, touching him, hesitating.

MOSHE (CONT'D)
(in a frail voice)
Oded...

Naomi runs over, shoves her father away with all the strength that has drained out of him.

NAOMI
Don't touch him! Don't you ever
touch him again!

His sister helps him sit up as he keeps moaning.

Moshe collapses, all too aware he has reached rock bottom.

16 INT. GLOBERMAN HOUSE - 1935 - NIGHT 16

Someone insistently knocks on a closed door.

GLOBERMAN (O.S.)
Who's there?

The door opens on Globerman who is wearing his pajamas.

In front of him in the darkness: Moshe in despair. He only utters a few pained words.

MOSHE
Bring that woman here.

Globerman does not have the time to answer as Moshe heads straight into the darkness.

A calm, but suffering, elderly voice...

LEAH (V.O.)
*Dear Etty, I'm writing this letter
for you to read when I am no longer
around.*

17 INT. ESTHER'S HOME - BEDROOM - 1978 - DAY 17

The letter with the opened sealing wax is now on the bed
Esther is slowly packing a large suitcase.

LEAH (V.O.)
*My memories are fading bit by bit,
and in a few years, I won't even
recognize myself in the mirror.
(MORE)*

LEAH (V.O.) (CONT'D)

That's why, while I still have time, I decided you should have the possibility of finding out some things that concern you. To do that, you will have to go to Israel, where you were born, back when a state by that name did not even exist.

FADE TO:

18 EXT. SEASHORE - SUNSET

18

The sound of the sea over the ripped photograph of Shimon Horwitz holding the baby. Wrapped in a cardigan, with no-makeup, Esther is standing in front of the sea, smoking a cigarette. She studies the photograph, then takes the letter.

LEAH (V.O.)

You have to track down a woman by the name of Yehudit who lived in a farming settlement. This woman had a son in 1935.

Esther looks towards the horizon and takes a few cigarette drags.

LEAH (V.O.)

The pendant and the photograph might help you find her. Don't blame me if I don't tell you more, but I don't even know the whole story. It's important that you are the one to do this, and I hope one day you'll understand why. With love, Mom.

Esther throws the cigarette into the sea that washes it away.

19 EXT. JERUSALEM - STREETS OLD CITY - 1978 - DAY

19

Esther, with a Canon around her neck, walks along a narrow street in the old city teeming with diversity: patrolling soldiers, long-haired young men and young women in bell-bottom jeans, groups of tourists, and pilgrims. A sumptuous celebration of noise, smells, and colors spills from shops and stands.

She reaches the entrance of a building, checks the address, and rings the doorbell.

20 INT. NURSING HOME - 1978 - DAY

20

In the distance, we see Esther through a glass door: she is talking with a 75-year-old WOMAN in a wheelchair. A NURSE stands between them, acting as interpreter.

Esther takes out the pendant and the photograph and shows them to the old woman.

The woman puts on her glasses and studies the two objects, turning them over in her hands. Then, apologetic, she shakes her head. Esther takes them back, disappointed.

ARONSTAM (V.O.)
Why didn't you tell me?

21 INT. ARONSTAM'S OFFICE - 1978 - DAY

21

Esther is sitting in front of a messy desk, piled with files belonging to a thin lawyer with a receding hairline, ARONSTAM (60). His office is informal and purely utilitarian. Esther listens to him, stiff.

ARONSTAM
It was imprudent of you to go, do
you realize that?

ESTHER
Imprudent? It's a hospice! What was
the danger, the old ladies
rebellious?

The lawyer stretches in his chair.

ARONSTAM
Mrs. Horwitz...

ESTHER
(cold)
Ms. You gave me some contacts, and
I made the first appointment.
That's all. I'm still alive.

ARONSTAM
(sarcastic)
Mazel Tov! If you allow me to
speak, I will explain. Josh
suggested you call me not only to
track down this woman...

Esther sighs.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)
But also to be there for you if you
need help in the search. To counsel
you...

ESTHER

I'll decide about that, if you don't mind.

ARONSTAM

Oh, of course. Allow me to give you some advice. You don't know anyone, and you don't know this country. You don't know why you're looking for these people, nor what you might find. It might be a matter of inheritance... or legal issues... even a crime. We don't know. That's why it would be best not to state the real motive for your search right away. Nor to tell them your real identity. Best be cautious, are you following me?

Esther relaxes and lights a cigarette.

ESTHER

So, what can I do?

Aronstam leafs through some papers.

ARONSTAM

Well, to start with, your family's history could provide us with some clues. What do you know about the period before they lived here?

ESTHER

Almost nothing. For me, Haifa's just the "birthplace" on my passport. I was three years old when they left for the States and nobody ever talked about Israel at home... nobody told stories in front of the fireplace, nothing like that. I figure once my parents got to America, they wanted to start over.

ARONSTAM

(thoughtful)

I see. Well, there are some things you could find out. For instance, if your parents moved to Haifa from another area. Or if they lived together with others who might be able to lead us to this Yehudit.

ESTHER

My parents are dead. How can I find out more?

ARONSTAM

The Arkhiyon Medinat Yisra'el... the national archive of Israel... is here in Jerusalem. All the registers from that time are conserved there. You could consult them... it's your right, you were born here...

Esther exhales some smoke, a bit polemical.

ESTHER

Do you think I read Hebrew?

Aronstam smiles.

ARONSTAM

They are in English. At the time, Israel did not exist. The territory was under the British crown.

He takes a file from the desk.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

As far as the other leads go, I'm waiting for some replies. The relatives of one Yehudit Gruen, are in Australia... I'm trying to get their contact information... in the meantime, though... there is this Yehudit...

Aronstam takes out another piece of paper.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

... she died many years ago, at the time she was living in a moshav...

ESTHER

What's a moshav?

ARONSTAM

Do you know what a kibbutz is?

ESTHER

More or less...

ARONSTAM

Well, moshavs were workers' cooperative settlements in the country side. They had a socialist spirit although the plots were private property... still the decisions were taken by...

Esther cuts him short, not particularly interested in the explanation.

ESTHER

You were telling me about this
Yehudit...

ARONSTAM

Oh, yes... this woman had a son who
has put a house up for sale in the
moshav.

The lawyer hands her the file.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

That could be your excuse to
contact him. He wasn't born in
1935, but something might come of
it, who knows?

Esther grabs the file, but she isn't very convinced.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

(passionately)

...how can you not fall in love with
such a specimen...?

22

INT. DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGY - CLASSROOM - DAY

22

The image of a small pink-and-green feathered bird.

A man in his forties (**ZAYDE RABINOVICH**) with beard and mussy hair, quite attractive, is sitting at his desk in front of a STUDENT (22) who is in the middle of his oral exam. On the benches behind the student, other students consult one another, anxiously.

The student stares at him, nervous. He doesn't have a clue what to say.

STUDENT

Right... so... yes... I mean... this
species is... rare?

ZAYDE

(wry)

I hope so for you, otherwise you
shouldn't have asked me...

Some giggles travel through the class. The student smiles too. Zayde maintains an accommodating, but resigned air. He gives him a hint...

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Pharomachrus mocinno...the quetzal.

The student looks even more insecure now.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
We're dealing here with a typical example of the species whose destiny is tightly woven with man's fate and culture. For the Mayans, it was a sort of divinity, a bit like the jackal for the Egyptians, the god Anubis... Understand?

The student is confused. Zayde sighs, discouraged.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
... the blackbird... why don't you tell me about the blackbird...

Relieved, the student changes his expression.

23

INT. DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGY - CORRIDOR - DAY

23

Zayde leaves the classroom and joins the loud corridor with the usual flow of students coming and going.

ESTHER
Excuse me...

Zayde turns around and sees Esther. She holds out her hand.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
I'm Sarah Hedelman. Do you speak English?

Zayde nods, a bit annoyed but also curious.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
(confident)
I wanted to talk to you about the house for sale in Beit Caleb.

Zayde frowns and corrects her pronunciation.

ZAYDE
Beit Caleb.

ESTHER
Yeah, that one. I saw the ad. I called your number, but there was a voicemail with, I guess your wife's voice... saying something in Hebrew...

ZAYDE
She's not my wife. She's my sister.

ESTHER
Oh, okay. Anyway, the agency sent me here and... here I am.
(MORE)

ESTHER (CONT'D)

So the house belongs to your sister, too?

ZAYDE

Yes, and to another sibling... why?

ESTHER

Nothing, just... curious. So you're in charge of the sale?

Zayde nods and looks at his watch.

ZAYDE

I guess so... listen, I have class soon, I'm sorry...

ESTHER

Yes, of course. I won't take up any more of your time. I'm interested in buying something in that area, but I'm leaving in a few days... Can we make an appointment to look at the house?

Evasive, Zayde ruffles his hair.

ZAYDE

Well, you see...

Ruth (O.S.)

(in Hebrew)

I waited for you at Eitan's house Thursday night...

Zadye turns to his side where an attractive 35-year-old woman (RUTH) is staring at him. He looks evasive, embarrassed. Esther watches them, without understanding. Zadye gestures Esther to wait and turns to speak to Ruth.

ZAYDE

Sorry, Ruth, but... I had...

RUTH

You could have at least called me. Who is she?

Zayde looks at Esther then Ruth.

ZAYDE

No one. An American. She wants to buy the country house. Can we talk at another time?

RUTH

When, exactly? In a month or maybe in a year? You think I'm one of your students?

Zayde replies with a little sarcasm.

ZAYDE

I have a great relationship with
my students...

RUTH

Spare me your jokes, Zayde. They
don't work on me. Not anymore.

Ruth walks away and turns also to Esther in a formal tone.

RUTH (CONT'D)

(in English)

Sorry for the interruption..
Goodbye.

Esther smiles back at her politely.

Somewhat relieved, Zayde, clears his voice then glances at
his watch again.

ZAYDE

I really need to go... call me back
at that number... I'll see what I
can do...

ESTHER

At what time?

Zayde is already walking away.

ZAYDE

Try tomorrow night. See you.

Zayde disappears as Esther loses the polite smile and
appears frustrated.

24 INT. STATE ARCHIVES - CONSULTATION ROOM - 1978 - DAY 24

The birth register, in English, with Leah Baron's application
for naturalization, dated 1930 with a photograph attached.

Esther studies it with a hint of a smile then shuts the
binder containing the birth certificate.

She is sitting at a table in a bright, large hall with two
large boxes in front of her. Around her, another dozen
visitors are consulting similar boxes and binders.

The first box in front of Esther is marked "Immigration,
Haifa, 1930" and the second one "Birth Certificates, Haifa,
1931-1934". (The writings on the boxes are in Hebrew).

From this second box, Esther takes out a binder with the
letter H.

She leafs through the certificates contained in the binder. She stops. She turns a few pages backwards. Then forward again. On the screen we see several birth certificates with the surname Horwitz, but nothing with the name Esther.

Esther frowns, then she stands up holding the two binders, and approaches an ARCHIVES EMPLOYEE sitting at the information desk at the entrance of the hall.

ESTHER

Excuse me, the only thing I've found is this application from my family...

The man looks at Leah's certificate. Esther then hands him the second binder.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

But I haven't found anything about my father and I couldn't find my own birth certificate, either.
(argumentative)
How is that possible?

The man leafs through the documents, frowning.

ARCHIVES EMPLOYEE

Look, I don't know what to tell you. All the documents from the Mandate are here. But over the years, probably a few of them have been destroyed...

Esther appears disappointed and frustrated.

ESTHER

Destroyed, you say. Right...

25 I/E. NAOMI'S HOUSE - ZAYDE'S ROOM/LIVING ROOM - 1978 - DAY 25

A building in the outskirts of the city at sunset.

CUT TO:

Luke Skywalker looks down from a Star Wars poster on the wall above a twin bed where Zadye is reading a book with a Hebrew title and a picture of the ethologist Lorenz surrounded by ducks. Pennants of basket ball teams and photos of kids on a school trip decorate the walls. Loud music coming from a record player.

Someone knocks at the door.

NAOMI (O.S.)

Zayde, dinner's ready!

Zayde keeps reading.

ZAYDE

Yes Naomi, I'm coming!

NAOMI RABINOVICH (50), grey hair, no make up, dressed in basic clothing with a t-shirt and a long skirt, opens the door, folds her arms and gives him a reproachful look. Zayde turns to her, annoyed.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

I'm coming, let me finish this page. And don't barge into my room, you know I hate it.

Without replying, Naomi shuts the door.

A voice is reading the summary of the days' news.

SPEAKER (V.O.)

(in Hebrew)

... the withdrawal of troops from the south of Lebanon continues... a new wave of protests in the West Bank against the Camp David Accords..... the assembly of the United Nations has renewed their invitation to the PLO to take part in the debate on the...

Someone abruptly mutes the audio.

ODED (O.S.)

These treaties are useless, trust me...

In the small living room next to the open kitchen, Zayde, Naomi, her husband **MEIR** (50), and **ODED** (55) are clearing the table, they have just finished eating. Meir looks good for his age, but Oded with his mustache and receding hairline is overweight.

Naomi looks at her brother, irritated.

NAOMI

So, what should they do? Let's hear it. Always with this defeatist attitude of yours, Oded.

ODED

Defeatist? I'm defeatist?

NAOMI

The Accords are just a scam, that's what you think, but an agreement is an agreement. You have to meet half-way otherwise what kind of agreement would it be?

MEIR

(interrupting her)

"Meeting half way", those are the kind of words I want to hear my wife say more...

Everyone chuckles except Naomi who looks at him, half-resigned and half-scorning. Oded picks up where they left off.

ODED

I'm not defeatist, Naomi. I'm a realist, am I right, Meir?

Meir nods, thinking on it. Naomi looks at one and then the other. Then she walks off, annoyed.

NAOMI

I give up on you three. We'll never get anywhere with that thinking. You and everyone else, you only know how to complain.

ZAYDE

(caustic and lazy)

Actually, I didn't say a word. I would have rather listened to the news than to you three bicker.

After a pause, Zayde starts talking elusively.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Oh, by the way, today... a woman came to the faculty to ask about the house.

The three exchange a surprised look. Zayde stands up.

NAOMI

Really? And...?

ZAYDE

She's American... and she is interested in buying something in that area... she would like to visit it.

Zayde puts his jacket on. Naomi insists.

NAOMI

So have you made an appointment to go?

(beat)

Zayde... are you going out?

ZAYDE

I'm going for a beer with Asher.
No, no appointment, not yet, I
don't know, we'll see.

ODED

What do you mean we'll see? What
are you waiting for? Americans are
willing to spend a fortune on real
estate that has a bit of history to
it...

Oded chuckles, as Zayde tries to avoid everyone's stares.

ZAYDE

Oded, we're talking about a farm
house... not the Colosseum... When will
you stop with all the clichés about
Americans?

NAOMI

Well... I'd say for once, Oded isn't
all wrong...

ZAYDE

Look, Naomi... I don't know... I've got
the university, and then, I'd have
to go all the way there, and
probably nothing will come of it...

ODED

You're the one who decided to take
care of it. Well, take care of it.
And don't use the university as an
excuse. I may think in clichés... but
you are the world champion of
excuse-making...

Meir lights a cigarette, Oded snatches one from him.

NAOMI

You don't want to get rid of that
house, admit it...

ZAYDE

Oh, God, Naomi, please don't you
start too...

NAOMI

If that's your reaction, I must be
right.

ZAYDE

(impatient)
Just stop already?

NAOMI

Ok, I'll stop, but you have to listen. You've been teaching in Jerusalem for a year, and you still haven't found an apartment. I don't even know if you're looking for one.

ZAYDE

I'm looking for one, but if you don't want to have me around...

NAOMI

(interrupting him)

Don't even start with that, please. We're happy to have you here, but are you planning to sleep in your nephew's room until he's back from military service?

Zayde mumbles something and leaves.

26

INT. DR. SANDOVAL'S OFFICE - 1978 - DAY

26

A bare and impersonal office. Sitting at his desk, **DOCTOR SANDOVAL**, a youthful sixty-year-old looks up from the test results in his hands, his expression worried. Then he looks over at Zayde sitting on the examination table bare-chested.

ZAYDE

May I put my clothes back on?

The doctor nods. Zayde buttons up his shirt.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Anyway, I feel much better... I'm more energetic. I have more of an appetite... better, you know.

Dr. Sandoval peers at him over his glasses, skeptically, and then looks back at the results.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL

Wonderful. Really. You must feel ready to run a marathon...

Zayde's smile fades a bit. The doctor takes off his glasses and stares at him.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL (CONT'D)

Listen... Leukemia isn't a head cold, you know that. Unfortunately, it doesn't disappear when its symptoms do. Are you doing the therapy?

ZAYDE
(on edge)
Is it even necessary?

DOCTOR SANDOVAL
(losing his patience a
bit)
Since we've had to exclude a marrow
transplant because of the
uncertainty in your... family
situation, yes, I would say so. In
any case, it can be palliative to
continue with the cure.

Zayde looks at him, disenchanted. He hops off the examination table and slips on his jacket. Sandoval writes out on a prescription tablet.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL (CONT'D)
Repeat the blood work in a month.

Then he hands it to him, staring at him, serious.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL (CONT'D)
One month.

Zayde nods and grabs the prescription with a smile.

27 INT. HOSPITAL - CORRIDOR - 1978 - DAY 27

Zayde walks out of the doctor's office and into the hallway, holding the prescription. He turns the corner and tosses it in the waste paper basket as he goes.

28 I/E. ZAYDE'S CAR - ROAD - JERUSALEM HOTEL - 1978 - DAY 28

Tense, Zayde distractedly looks at himself in the rearview mirror of his car, a beat-up Morris. He runs his hand through his shaggy hair and fixes the collar of his shirt.

Suddenly, he stares at something ahead: Esther is coming out of an hotel onto the street. He watches her for a few seconds, skeptical, then he gets out of his car and attracts her attention waving at her.

Esther notices him and walks over, a bit guarded. She is wearing a jacket with a shirt and necklaces, a colourful skirt and heel boots.

They shake hands and exchange polite smiles. Zayde's gaze lingers on her clothing.

ZAYDE
Are you coming like that?

Esther looks at herself a bit embarrassed.

ESTHER

Why? What's wrong?

ZAYDE

No, no, nothing... Just that, I mean
it's a farmhouse in the country
and...

ESTHER

I know, but I didn't think we were
going to harvest wheat.

Zayde gives a small forced laugh.

ZAYDE

Not the season for it.

He gets in the car as Esther opens the door on the passenger
side, annoyed.

29 EXT. BUS STATION - 1935 - DAY

29

A truck stops at a crossroads between two dirt roads. Fields
all around.

A few people with luggage step out of the truck and walk
away. The last person to step out is a woman of about 35,
YEHUDIT SOLOMON. She is dark-haired and trim with strong yet
harmonious features. Her deep dark eyes and piercing gaze are
striking. She has a proud, naturally elegant demeanor, lean
yet lady-like. She is carrying a big string-tied suitcase.
She looks around for someone, but she seems relaxed.

Nearby, on the cart, Moshe and his children are watching the
woman. He makes an awkward gesture with his hand in order to
be noticed. She walks over, austere.

YEHUDIT

I am Yehudit Solomon.

He gets down, awkward and careful, unable to meet her glance
while she, on the other hand, comfortably stares him in the
eye.

MOSHE

Rabinovich... Moshe Rabinovich.

She looks over at the two children, gazing at them sweetly.

MOSHE (CONT'D)

This is Oded, and this is Naomi... my
children...

The two children react differently: Naomi is welcoming but
Oded is dismissive. He keeps looking in another direction.
But nothing seems to faze Yehudit.

Moshe picks up Yehudit's suitcase effortlessly and places it on the cart where the children are already seated. Before she sits, Yehudit states a firm condition.

YEHUDIT

I'm sitting on the right.

Caught off guard, Moshe doesn't respond and has Naomi move. When they are all settled, Yehudit explains, showing no sign of embarrassment.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

I can't hear out of my right ear.

Moshe turns to look at her, taken aback.

30

EXT. CITRUS GROVE - FIELDS - 1935 - DAY

30

On the top of a ladder, intent on picking oranges from a tree, Yaakov stops to peek into a sparrow nest.

YAAKOV

(to Rivka below)

There's a nest of wild canaries...
incredible, I've never seen one of
these up close. Best we don't pick
the oranges here...

Rivka, busy picking the oranges on the lower branches, shakes her head.

RIVKA

If you're planning on leaving the
oranges on all the trees that have
nests, we're going to go home empty-
handed, Yaakov.

He doesn't respond. He shrugs and starts to climb down, but Moshe's approaching cart attracts his curiosity.

CUT TO:

The cart continues among the swaying wheat fields under the dark cloudy sky. Yehudit looks around, expressionless. While Naomi watches her in fascination, Oded keeps frowning.

CUT TO:

Yaakov is about to look away from the approaching cart, when suddenly the clouds open a crack and **a ray of sunlight shines on Yehudit's face**. Then the light disappears, then reappears and disappears again. The play of light and shadows on her from the passing clouds entrances Yaakov: **Yehudit looks like she herself is shining... as if she stepped out of a dream.**

Rivka follows her husband's gaze and notices her too. But in Rivka's eyes, Yehudit doesn't appear any better or any worse than what she is.

RIVKA (CONT'D)
Must be the woman who's come to
work for Rabinovich...

Yaakov doesn't pay any attention to her. Still rattled by his vision, he stares off at the cart driving away.

31 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY

31

The cart reaches the farmyard. Moshe, followed by Naomi, leads Yehudit towards the house. Oded refuses to follow them and goes to curl up beneath the eucalyptus.

Yehudit looks at the top of the tree swaying in the wind. She remains a few moments staring at the leaves.

CUT TO:

In front of the emporium, around an old truck, Globerman is in a heated discussion with a friendly-looking Arab merchant (HASSAN, 40).

GLOBERMAN
Hassan, only two things count in
business: profit and gain. This is
a rusty old truck. Three fifty, and
we have a deal.

Hassan laughs, shaking his head.

HASSAN
Think a fox can cheat another fox?
Five, take it or leave it.

Globerman chuckles, then, out of the corner of his eye, noticing Moshe's cart, he stops to watch what is going on. He keeps his eye trained on the new arrival. With his business acumen and skills in assessment, he looks her over, lingering on her ankles, shoulders, and arms.

GLOBERMAN
(to himself)
Good for you, Moshe Rabinovich...

32 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - KITCHEN - 1935 - DAY

32

Yehudit, Moshe and Naomi enter the house. Yehudit silently explores the modest house: two rooms and an untidy kitchen. Moshe tries to decipher her enigmatic expression...

MOSHE

(awkward)

If you decide to stay... I'll build a wall and make a room for you...

Yehudit doesn't answer, staring towards the farmyard where something has caught her attention. Naomi hasn't missed a thing, explains to her father...

NAOMI

You just talked in her deaf ear.

Moshe moves to go to the other ear, but before he has a chance to repeat what he said, Yehudit moves outside, drawn to something in the farmyard. Moshe and Naomi follow.

33

I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - STABLE - 1935- DAY

33

Yehudit reaches the stable, stops at the door, and looks at Moshe, as if asking permission to enter, more out of respect than fear. He leads her in.

Yehudit cautiously enters. A few cows turn to look at her, mooing.

Her gaze lingers on a corner in the back, empty of animals and farm tools.

Confused by her long silence, Moshe breaks the ice.

MOSHE

Do you know how to milk cows? We start at six here and...

She calmly interrupts him and points to the corner.

YEHUDIT

I'll set myself up here.

Moshe looks toward the corner.

MOSHE

Here? Here in the stable... with the cows? But... what will everyone say if I have you sleep here?

YEHUDIT

What would they say if I slept under your roof? I don't need much... Just a bed frame and mattress, then I'll fix the rest up myself.

(beat)

Oh... and two nails to hang up a curtain.

Moshe is about to insist otherwise, but he realizes it's impossible to sway her.

He glances at Naomi, searching for comfort, but the little girl is completely taken with whatever Yehudit does. Moshe scratches his head and heads out.

YEHUDIT (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Anyway, no... I don't know how to
milk a cow. But... I'm a quick
learner.

Moshe stops at the door and turns to look at her.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)
If then you decide not to keep me
on, I'll find some place else...

Moshe stares at her without answering. Then he goes out.

34 I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY 34

A large nail being hammered into a wall. Moshe drives it in and looks at Yehudit, awaiting her approval. She looks at the two nails stuck in her new corner. Then she takes a flowered sheet from her suitcase and unfolds it, thinking of what to do.

YEHUDIT
I'll need some wire and rings.

Moshe thinks for a moment, then goes out into the farmyard.

Expertly, Moshe inspects the terrain near the sawhorse. He finds one nail, then another, and another.

He starts bending a nail with his fingers, fashioning it into a ring.

From inside the stable, Yehudit's eyes stare at Moshe's strong fingers.

FADE TO:

Naomi's delighted face peeks in through the sheet that is now a curtain hanging from the wire thanks to the rings made from the nails, transforming the corner of the stable into a room.

Yehudit seems satisfied as she arranges her few belongings on the windowsill.

Naomi looks in and smiles, admiring the transformation.

35 I/E. VILLAGE - MOSHE'S HOME - ROOMS -1935 - NIGHT 35

Darkest night. As the settlement sleeps, the wind and muffled noises of night creatures vibrate in the countryside.

Suddenly, **a scream pierces the silence of the settlement.**

CUT TO:

Naomi wakes with a start. She leaves the bed where Oded is still sleeping and heads over to the window. She looks out at the stable in the distance. The scream is coming from there.

Worried, the girl goes to her father and finds him at the window, staring at the stable.

NAOMI

Maybe she's hurt. Go see!

He turns toward Naomi to reassure her.

MOSHE

She must have her reasons. We'll let her be.

36 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - ROOM - 1935 - NIGHT 36

Yehudit's wail echoes, reaching Yaakov and Rivka's house.

At the bedroom window, Yaakov looks out into the distance at Rabinovich's stable. He's more attracted than disturbed.

In the bed behind him, Rivka is scrutinizing him, concerned.

37 EXT. GLOBERMAN'S HOUSE - 1935 - NIGHT 37

Globerman is heading back into his house, his jacket over his shoulder. Yehudit's scream makes him stop and look out, trying to understand where it's coming from. When he understands, his expression turns mischievous.

38 I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAWN 38

The next morning, everything seems back to normal. The reassuring countryside sounds of hens, cows, and birds fill the air.

Moshe heads over to the stable with two empty milk churns. He is about to go in, but he pauses, and knocks.

Yehudit immediately comes out, as if she were just behind the door, waiting. They greet each other with a nod. No questions.

Yehudit heads to the house. Moshe watches her go by and then goes into the stable.

39 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - KITCHEN - 1935 - DAY

39

When Moshe enters, carrying some eggs, the children are sitting at the table in front of a simple, yet beautifully-prepared breakfast. The kitchen has been cleaned and tidied. Yehudit is taking a freshly baked loaf of bread out of the oven.

Moshe is speechless. Yehudit makes a simple statement that leaves no room for contestation.

YEHUDIT

I cook everything. Except lentils.

Moshe nods. Naomi is eating, enjoying the food, while Oded, frowning, is waiting for Yehudit to leave before digging in. Content, Moshe cuts a thick slice of bread for himself.

40 INT. ZAYDE'S CAR - 1978 - DAY

40

As they drive through fields of crops and citrus groves, Esther takes out a cigarette.

ESTHER

Mind if I smoke?

Zayde holds back his annoyance and rolls down the car window.

ZAYDE

Be my guest...

Esther lights her cigarette just the same.

ESTHER

Wow, this landscape is... well, it's really different from ours.

ZAYDE

What do you mean by different?

ESTHER

I don't know, exactly. I guess I was expecting something more... majestic. Considering the way people keep fighting over it.

Zayde shifts a bit in his car seat. He replies, sarcastically.

ZAYDE

We don't have the Grand Canyon, if that's what you mean...

(changing the subject)

What do you do for a living?

ESTHER

I work for an airline. I'm a stewardess.

Zayde looks at her, impressed.

ZAYDE

Really? So you're always traveling..

ESTHER

Not anymore. For the last couple of years, I've been working at the airport. But yes, I've traveled quite a bit. What about you? What do you teach?

ZAYDE

Well, my job has something to do with flying too.. I'm an ornithologist.

ESTHER

Oh, so.. birds, then..

Zayde nods, irritated.

ZAYDE

How come you decided to buy something in this area?

ESTHER

I was born in Israel, and--

ZAYDE

Really?

ESTHER

Yeah, really. In Haifa. But we left before I was even three years old. I don't remember anything, obviously. Anyway, my parents are gone and I thought... hey, why not go back to my roots? Maybe spend vacations here.

ZAYDE

Vacations, sure...

Zayde's tone betrays a slight judgment. Esther smiles, containing her annoyance.

41 EXT. SETTLEMENT/ MOSHE'S HOUSE - 1978 - DAY

41

The car drives through the streets of the settlement, now unrecognizable because of the modern homes and lush vegetation. The water tower peeking out is among the things that have remained.

Zayde's Morris parks in front of the old house, still recognizable, even though it looks partially abandoned. They get out of the car. Esther looks around. Obviously she was expecting something different.

ZAYDE

No one has lived in the house for years...

Facing the courtyard, the stable now is connected to the old house by a cement patch. A second stable has been built nearby. All that is left of the eucalyptus tree is a stump covered with shoots.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

What do you think?

Esther takes the camera out of her bag and goes over to the house. She touches the walls. A little bit of whitewash comes off on her fingers. She brushes it off.

ESTHER

Well, it's a very different style from an American country house.
(indicating her camera)
May I?

ZAYDE

Go right ahead... anyway, the "style" was the last thing they were thinking about.

As she takes a few photographs of the house and courtyard, Esther realizes she has to change her tack.

ESTHER

That's not what I meant. Did you live here, too?

ZAYDE

Yes, I was born precisely in there.

Proud, he points to the ex-stable.

42 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1935 - DAY

42

Globerman cautiously spies into the stable and spots Yehudit, half-hidden by the curtain. **She's sipping some liquor from a bottle.** Then, she hides it under the hay.

Globerman grins, pleased. He knocks loudly, formally takes off his hat, clears his voice and comes forward with a slight bow, closing the door behind him.

GLOBERMAN

These accommodations are not worthy
of you, madame...

Yehudit looks him over without making a comment. Globerman backtracks, reassuring her.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

I'm Globerman... I trade cattle all
over this area. I talked to my
brother about you working here...

YEHUDIT

(cold)
I'll call Rabinovich.

GLOBERMAN

No rush, madame. I'm one of the
family here. But... how does a woman
like you end up doing a job like
this?

Yehudit icily cuts him off, annoyed.

YEHUDIT

One job's as good as another.

The sound of the door cuts off the conversation. Moshe enters the holding milking buckets. As he walks past the merchant, he makes a wry joke betraying a tinge of annoyance.

MOSHE

No cows to sell you today,
Globerman.

GLOBERMAN

(chuckling.)
There's more to life than cows,
Rabinovich.

Moshe goes to sit on a stool next to a cow while Globerman takes leave with another bow.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

'Till we meet again, madame...

Expressionless, Yehudit looks him over as he leaves. Moshe motions for her to come near. Yehudit takes a stool and sits next to him. He starts to milk the cow. The rhythmic metallic sound of the milk hitting the sides of the bucket accompanies his calm voice, making his explanation even more engaging.

MOSHE

See... you have to squeeze like this
so the udder fills the palm of your
hand... hold the base still with your
fingers when you squeeze down... like
this... don't pull... squeeze your
fingers from the middle towards
your pinky to get it out. Gentle,
but decisive...

Yehudit nods, rapt, her eyes staring at the man's calloused yet gentle fingers. For a moment, their eyes meet. The intimacy makes them both uncomfortable.

Moshe is the first to avert his eyes, and then she does too.

MOSHE (CONT'D)

Anyway, it's just a matter of
practice. You try.

They exchange places.

43

EXT. SETTLEMENT - 1935 - DAY

43

Along a road in the middle of the settlement, under heavy clouds threatening rain, Yaakov is walking home lugging two sacks of grain. In the distance, he can make out Yehudit carrying bags of shopping walking towards him.

The man stops, intrigued. He keeps on walking just as the rain starts coming down.

When he is just a few steps from Yehudit, he plants himself in front of her, forcing her to stop. She remains composed, frowning because he's wasting her time.

YAAKOV

Hello, I'm Yaakov Scheinfeld. I
live in front...

She walks around him, answering, curt.

YEHUDIT

I know.

Smiling satisfied, Yaakov watches her as she walks off, heedless of the raindrops speckling his face. Yehudit slips off on her way never turning to look back.

44

I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - STABLE - 1935 - DAY

44

Yehudit dashes across the farmyard, the pouring rain beating down.

She enters the stable, soaking wet, her legs muddy. There, she finds Globerman waiting for her with his sly smile and a bottle-shaped package resting on the trough.

GLOBERMAN

A little something for madame
Yehudit...

She looks him over as she tries to dry off with a handkerchief, then a quick but interested glance at the gift. Globerman stares at her muddy calves.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

Such a pity your beautiful legs
have to get so dirty...

Then he fixes his hat, commenting to himself.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

How can Rabinovich live with you
and not go crazy?

Haughty and enigmatic, Yehudit ignores his complement.

YEHUDIT

I don't live with anyone.

Outside the stable, Moshe has been listening in on their conversation, ignoring the downpour.

45

EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY

45

The sun is shining again on the muddy farmyard. Moshe is using a wheelbarrow to dump cement into a dug-out furrow to create a pathway leading from the stable to the house.

Papish is sitting on his tractor, as Oded tinkers with its running engine.

ODED

You can turn it off, Papish, I
fixed it...

PAPISH

(turning the engine off)
Well done Oded, I'll propose to
the Workers' Council to make you
chief mechanic of Beit Caleb!

As Moshe giggles in satisfaction, Oded glares at Yehudit who is exiting the stable. The woman glances briefly at Moshe, then heads towards the house.

ODED

Why didn't you make a path when mom
was alive?

Moshe answers his son, as he continues to work.

MOSHE

When she was here, I built
everything else.

Oded, not satisfied with that answer, keeps glaring at Yehudit who turns to him before she goes into the house and smiles, flustering him.

46 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1935 - DAY

46

The cement for the path is dry and solid. While Yehudit and the children watch, Moshe removes the protective planks over the path.

Naomi wants to be the first to try it out. She skips over it, enjoying herself, happy. Then she runs and takes Yehudit by the hand.

NAOMI

Come, Yehudit! Come on, try it!

Yehudit would rather not, but the girl's enthusiasm wins her over. They both step onto the path, and Naomi leads her in a little dance on the immaculate concrete. Yehudit, amused, exchanges a look with Moshe who looks down, shy, but satisfied. Only Oded remains aloof.

47 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1935 - DAY

47

Pulling a handcart and holding two cages of canaries, Yaakov reaches the farmyard where Rivka is hanging out laundry. His wife watches him, questioningly.

RIVKA

What are you doing with those?

Satisfied, he admires the chirping birds.

YAAKOV

Aren't they beautiful? I'm putting
them in the shed.

RIVKA

(ignoring him)

We need to plow the field and...

YAAKOV

(interrupting)

Yes, yes, I'll deal with that
later...

As she watches him, resigned, Yaakov heads toward the shed.

48 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1935 - NIGHT

48

Moshe is stroking the back of a cow in the throes of labor. She moos and groans in pain. Moshe's eyes are tinged with anxiety. Yehudit is crouched next to the cow, observing the contractions, worried as well.

CUT TO:

A stillborn calf lies on the ground, its hoofs tied to a rope. Naomi and Oded, worried, watch their father drag the calf out of the stable, upset.

MOSHE

I'll go call Globerman. It needs to be butchered right away.

Moshe disappears outside.

Yehudit is still next to the cow, stroking her. Yehudit's good ear rests on the cow's side.

Suddenly, the cow lurches forward.

YEHUDIT

(to Oded)

Call your father. There's another one.

The boy hesitates, but her look is eloquent: she won't take no for an answer. Oded leaves to look for his father.

CUT TO:

Exhausted, Moshe and Oded stare at the cow, dead in a pool of blood. Yehudit is brushing a **strange newborn calf**. Naomi has fallen asleep on Yehudit's bed. Globerman studies the animal with skepticism.

GLOBERMAN

Half-female, half-male. Sterile, for sure. Only good for the slaughterhouse.

(to Moshe)

I'll take the cow, the calf, and this little creature. Not such a bad day's profit, Rabinovich. I can give you at least...

YEHUDIT

(cutting him off)

You're not taking her.

Moshe and Globerman turn to look at her, surprised.

GLOBERMAN

All due respect, I don't think this concerns you, Madame Yehudit.

Yehudit turns, imploring to Moshe.

YEHUDIT

Don't sell her to him. I'll take care of her. She might not be like he says. I beg of you, Moshe. If she costs you, I'll pay you back. This is the first and last thing I'll ever ask you.

Taken aback by her desperate tone, Moshe looks at the merchant, then looks at the heifer-calf, looks at Yehudit, and then looks down, scratching his neck.

MOSHE

Listen Globerman, you say it's actually a bull-calf. So, I'll sell it to you in six months, when you usually sell a bull-calf.

The merchant chuckles, amused.

GLOBERMAN

It's a freak of nature, Rabinovich! Just a piece of meat. In six months, I won't pay you anything more!

Globerman stares at Moshe waiting for a reaction. The merchant shakes his head and takes some money from his pocket.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

As you wish... and above all, as Madame Yehudit wishes...

(he hands Moshe the money)

Best I can do. Take it or leave it.

Moshe counts the money and puts it in his pocket without blinking an eye. Globerman goes over to the heifer-calf, wryly.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

See you in six months, little one... or are you going to name it?

YEHUDIT

(without a moment's hesitation)

Rachel. Her name is Rachel.

Globerman cackles.

Yaakov arrives, carrying a large object covered with a cloth in his arms.

He heads straight to Yehudit who is washing the laundry at the trough. Rachel is next to her, wearing a bell with a red belt around her neck, following her like a puppy.

YEHUDIT

What is it, Scheinfeld?

Yaakov pulls the cloth away, revealing a small cage holding a canary. As soon as the bird sees the light, it starts chirping.

Yehudit peers at it, suspicious.

YAAKOV

He's male. This is his mating song.

YEHUDIT

So?

YAAKOV

It's a present for you.

YEHUDIT

I don't need presents.

Yaakov leans on the edge of the trough with his elbows and stares at her. He plunges his hand in the water and starts to caress the surface.

YAAKOV

Our hands, like little fishes in the same water...

Yehudit looks at him, annoyed.

YEHUDIT

You're married. What do you want from me?

Yaakov replies cheerful and bold.

YAAKOV

Destiny brought us together...

She looks at him, skeptical and patronizing.

YEHUDIT

What are you hoping to get from someone you don't even know, Scheinfeld?

YAAKOV

(cheerful)

Well, then let's get to know each other!

Yehudit giggles, amused. She slaps the water, splashing him gleefully. And that splash is enough for him.

A glimmer of hope shines in Yaakov's smile. Ignoring his cage, she heads to the stable with the bucket.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

This was the stable... before I was born.

50 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1978 - DAY

50

The stable now looks like a real house: a wall divides it in two, white-washed walls and a kitchen nook. Everywhere are stacks of crates, trunks, and furniture.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

When I was little, I loved sniffing these walls... for years they still smelled of milk...

Zayde goes over to a wall, leaning against it and smells it, closing his eyes.

Esther is fascinated by this gesture. Esther listens to him as she looks at old photographs and postcards scattered on a table.

ESTHER

Such an odd place...
(she changes the subject)
Where were your parents from? I mean before they came here...

ZAYDE

(cold)
Are you trying to lower the price?

Esther looks at him questioningly.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Where they all came from back then.

Esther shakes her head, playful.

ESTHER

I'm serious. I hardly know anything. Fill me in.

Zayde smiles. He does not need to be asked twice.

ZAYDE

From Europe, especially the East. For the most part, people here were escaping... from pogroms, the Nazis, communism, centuries of persecutions... Many of them were socialists, dreaming of building a different world.

(MORE)

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

They bought the land from Arab owners... and started out here... from nothing. Then things didn't turn out exactly as expected, but... that was it at the beginning...

ESTHER

Pioneers, then... So you lived here with your parents?

Zayde hunches into himself.

ZAYDE

Yes, with my mother...

ESTHER

And your father?

51 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - KITCHEN - 1978 - DAY

51

Zayde pushes the front door open of the same house: A beam of light sparkling with dust fairies streams in, revealing a tidiness frozen in time. Esther follows Zayde, looking around.

ZAYDE

This was Moshe's house. He was one of my fathers...

ESTHER

Your mother remarried?

ZAYDE

(hesitant)

No... it's... complicated.

Esther does not insist. She focuses on a framed photograph hanging on the wall: it shows Yehudit holding a newborn surrounded by Yaakov, Globerman, Moshe and his two children. Everyone looks proud.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

This is in 1938.

Esther takes a photograph of the photo. Zayde proudly points out the different people in the photo as he speaks.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

That's me in my mother's arms. These are my siblings, Oded and Naomi, Moshe's children from his first wife, Tonia. They built this house. And these are my other two fathers... Yaakov Scheinfeld and Globerman... Everyone only ever called him by his last name.

Esther turns to look at him questioningly, but also rather amused.

ESTHER
So you really had three fathers...
how does that work?

Zadye shies away.

ZAYDE
So many questions...

Smiling, Esther tries to act casual.

ESTHER
Oh, I'm sorry, you're right, but
this story is...

Zayde looks at her in the eyes.

ZAYDE
Intriguing.

ESTHER
Well, yeah. It is.

Esther blushes, but she does not look away from Zayde's gaze.

52 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - SHED - 1935 - DAY

52

Rivka is leaving the house to do the shopping. Walking past the tool shed now **stuffed with canary cages**, she glances in.

Yaakov is writing in a notebook. He doesn't realize he is being watched.

RIVKA (O.S.)
You're always sniffing around
Rabinovich's house...

Yaakov turns, caught off guard. She stares at him for a long time, tense, but not angry.

RIVKA (CONT'D)
You're an idiot, Scheinfeld.

Yaakov is about to say something, but she has already left.

53 EXT. EMPORIUM - 1935 - DAY

53

Sitting on a few benches outside the community hall, Papish and some other farmers are playing checkers. Rivka appears on her way to the emporium. Papish, first, and then the others look over, their eyes glued to her. Before Rivka goes into the emporium, Yehudit comes out. Rivka stops, waiting for the other woman to come over.

YEHUDIT

Hello, Rivka.

Rivka doesn't answer. She stands, not moving. Yehudit keeps walking.

RIVKA

What do you want from him?

There is no anger in her voice, just humiliation. Yehudit turns and looks at her.
The men on the bench watch the scene, enjoying the face-off.

YEHUDIT

I'm not the one you should ask. I
don't want anything at all.

She goes on her way, leaving Rivka with her thoughts.

54

I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - YARD - STABLE - 1935 - DAY

54

Globerman, clearly not a seasoned driver, drives Hassan's truck into the farmyard. Instead of braking, he slows down, using the eucalyptus tree as a barrier to stop the vehicle. Not bothered in the least, the merchant grabs a wrapped bottle resting on the dashboard, hides it under his jacket, and heads toward the stable.
He stops at the threshold to watch Yehudit who is focused on trying to milk Rachel.

GLOBERMAN

Papish told me you tried to get his
bull to mount her...

Yehudit doesn't answer. He smirks.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

... and even that beast didn't want
her...

Yehudit squeezes harder, but nothing comes out of the udders.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

What do you expect? It's like
squeezing a dried-out lemon.

Yehudit lets go of the udders and stares at him, defiantly.

YEHUDIT

Papish's wife never had children,
but she nursed an orphan for three
years...

She goes back to milking with even more vigor.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

I am going to keep squeezing until
milk comes out of her udders even
if it makes my fingers bleed.

Globerman bursts into a friendly grin and shows her the bottle. Yehudit's expression changes. She stands up from the stool, gets two glasses from her "room" and goes over Globerman who is now sitting on top of a crate. As he pours the liquor, he speaks in a serious tone.

GLOBERMAN

You drink like a man, Yehudit. A
man drinks either to celebrate or
to forget. You?

She shrugs.

YEHUDIT

A nafka mina... What difference does
it make?

He stares into her.

GLOBERMAN

What will become of you in ten or
twenty years, Yehudit?

She replies, blunt.

YEHUDIT

I'm doing just fine.
(she raises her glass to
him)
I'm certainly not going to get
mixed up with a married man who has
three children.

GLOBERMAN

(confident)
Divorced, Madam. By mutual consent.

Yehudit nods, amused.

YEHUDIT

Benemunes parnuse?

He bursts out laughing, toasts her, and Yehudit clinks her glass to his. As Globerman drinks, he stares at her hungrily. She meets his gaze without embarrassment.

Yaakov comes out of the shed and spots Globerman's truck parked in Moshe's farmyard. Yaakov's expression hardens. He starts marching over.

Right then, Rivka comes out of the house, noticing him walking away. She is about to say something, but nothing comes out of her mouth.

She turns, and her gaze focuses on the shed. She strides toward it.

As soon as she goes in, the birds' chirping becomes deafening. Rivka takes in the surroundings: the sacks of bird feed, the bowls of water, the cuttlebone dangling in the cages. On a shelf, she spots her husband's notebook. She picks it up and leafs through the pages. Her eyes widen.

On each page is written one word: "Yehudit." The letters rearranged in every possible way: Yeuhdit, Tiduhey...

Desperate, Rivka hurls the notebook away.

56

E/I. SETTLEMENT - ROAD - TRUCK - 1935 - SUNSET

56

Globerman is driving in his unique improvisational manner down a road when a wild-eyed **Yaakov stands in the middle, blocking the way.**

Globerman swerves and slams on the brakes, but the truck hits Yaakov with a glancing blow before coming to a halt.

Unfazed that he was just hit by a truck, Yaakov starts shouting at Globerman.

YAAKOV

You have all the money you could
ever want! Leave Yehudit alone!

Stunned, Globerman can barely hear any of what he is saying from inside the truck because of the rumbling motor. He fumbles to turn it off. Then he gets out of the truck, takes off his hat, and hurls it to the ground.

GLOBERMAN

Scheinfeld, what the hell? Are you
insane?

Globerman notices blood trickling down Yaakov's forehead.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

You're bleeding, go get a bandage!

Yaakov touches his forehead. When he sees the blood, he staggers away, still upset.

YAAKOV

Think about what I told you,
Globerman!

Globerman shakes his head and picks up his hat.

57 EXT. SETTLEMENT - 1935 - SUNSET 57

Rivka, carrying a large suitcase, walks off alone down the road leading out of the settlement.

58 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1935 - SUNSET 58

Yaakov rushes inside the house, a bloody hand on his forehead. He goes to rinse his forehead in the sink, then he grabs a cloth and starts to staunch the wound.

Silence echoes in the house. He frowns, confused. He glances around and notices a note on the table: "For Yaakov". He picks it up and reads it, without reacting. Expressionless, he stares at a watercolor portrait of Rivka on the wall.

Then he slowly walks away.

The note remains open on the table stained with Yaakov's bloody fingerprints.

ESTHER (O.S.)

Rivka's story is really sad. What happened to her?

59 INT. CAFÉ - 1978 - DAY 59

Esther and Zayde are waiting for their food to arrive, sitting at a table in a café converted out of the old emporium.

ZAYDE

(distracted)

Some people say she left for America. I don't know.

Esther looks at him, slightly polemical.

ESTHER

It doesn't seem all that important to you.

Zayde gets a bit defensive.

ZAYDE

Well... I never met her. What should I say? Anyway, I don't think it was a very happy marriage.

Esther nods, bitter.

ESTHER

Yeah. What about you, Zayde? Are you married?

The sudden personal nature of the conversation confuses Zayde.

ZAYDE

Me? No, no... and you, Sarah?

ESTHER

Divorced. My marriage was unhappy, too...

Esther smiles. He smiles back and starts confiding.

ZAYDE

I have to tell you something. But don't get angry.

Esther is amused.

ESTHER

You forgot your wallet.

Zayde chuckles.

ZAYDE

Well. You should know that your job was my teenage erotic daydream.

Esther bursts out laughing.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Really, I swear. Unfortunately, I have traveled very little.

ESTHER

(still laughing)

You're not alone. One guy asked me to marry him on the Phoenix-New York route. He kept asking for two straight hours. But he was pretty drunk...

Zayde nods, amused. Esther takes advantage of the moment and **pulls the pendant out of her purse** and shows it to him, satisfied.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Do you like this? I bought it yesterday in Jerusalem. I think it might be worth something. I love jewelry...

She places it on top of her dress, trying to read Zayde's reaction. He seems more interested in her than the object.

ZAYDE

It becomes you. Looks good.

Esther points out the engraved date.

ESTHER

See this date? October 4, 1932. I wonder what it refers to.

Again no reaction: Zayde only has eyes for her.

Esther smiles, relieved. A waitress comes over with several plates brimming with colorful dishes. Esther looks radiant. Zayde turns to the waitress and speaks in Hebrew.

ZAYDE

Do you have some of the hummus you make with yogurt? I want my American friend to taste it.

The waitress looks at Esther and answers in Hebrew.

WAITRESS

The spicy one. Of course.

ZAYDE

Yes, that's the one. Thank you.

The waitress leaves and Zayde translates.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

She said you're very beautiful.

Esther smiles, amused.

ESTHER

You're kidding.

ZAYDE

No, it's true. You really are very beautiful.

She laughs out loud.

ESTHER

Even without the uniform?

They start eating. Their conversation cannot be heard. The atmosphere is warm. They are open and engaged.

Neil Young's **Heart of Gold** starts to play..

60

I/E. ZAYDE'S CAR - ROAD - 1978 - DAY

60

... out of Zayde's car stereo as he drives through a wide green valley. They chat, relaxed. Esther is in a playful mood.

ESTHER

Put on some good old American rock... and it suddenly feels like home.

ZAYDE

I have to give it to you Americans,
when it comes to music.

ESTHER

Music... movies... let's see...

ZAYDE

True, you guys know what you're
doing. In some things. But
"Americans" come from all over the
world. Including you.

Zayde smiles, then he notices something in distance.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Here we go.

Esther looks in the same direction: in front of them, an **army roadblock** with some soldiers, a truck, and a line of waiting cars carrying only Arabs, many with their families.

ESTHER

What's that?

ZAYDE

Nothing. Just a checkpoint.
Completely normal. They ask for
your papers, nothing more.

Esther struggles to hide her sudden anxiety.

ESTHER

Can't we take another road? I'm
American, I wouldn't want...

ZAYDE

Don't worry, I'll do the talking.
There's no problem. Get out your
passport.

Esther opens her bag and looks at the passport. She turns toward her window looking worried.

Zayde calmly slows down, driving past the line of waiting cars. As they pass the cars, a peek into the diverse humanity of their passengers.

ESTHER

Why aren't they moving ahead?

ZAYDE

They're Palestinian workers from
the West Bank, they have to be
checked...

Esther grows more and more tense.

A **SOLDIER** (20) approaches Zayde's car window and speaks in Hebrew.

SOLDIER

Papers.

Zayde hands his to him, greeting him in Hebrew.

ZAYDE

I'm taking around this American friend. She was born around here and is looking to buy a house.

Esther flashes a friendly, but nervous smile. The soldier quickly looks at Zayde's ID, then nods for Esther's. The soldier looks at her passport then her. She inhales to say something, but the soldier politely hands it back without another word and signals for them to drive on.

As they drive off, Esther gives a long sigh.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Are you okay? I'm sorry if you...

ESTHER

No, no. I'm fine, I'm just not used to this. It's kind of... scary.

ZAYDE

Yeah, that's life around here these days...

Esther changes the subject.

ESTHER

So, that story about the three fathers... when did you appear?

Zayde looks as if he has been waiting for nothing else but the chance to tell her...

61 MONTAGE: E/I. YAAKOV'S HOUSE/EMPORIUM/SETTLEMENT-1936-DAY 61

Rhythmic music grows in a frenetic crescendo. Surrounded by the canaries in the shed, Yaakov, looking like he's in a trance, is furiously writing on yellow slips of paper scattered throughout the house.

CUT TO:

Yaakov sticks a yellow note on the settlement notice board: "Yaakov Scheinfeld is madly in love with Yehudit Solomon and will wait for her until the day he dies."

CUT TO:

Another note on the wall of the emporium: "Yehudit, you are my destiny."

CUT TO:

More notes stuck on the poles of the street lights.

CUT TO:

In a symphonic crescendo, more notes are stuck on tree trunks.

CUT TO:

Papish and a crowd of onlookers read and comment on the many notes on the notice board. An older man reads one out loud: "Yehudit, will you come to the river with me tomorrow?" Papish writes an answer in pencil below: "I'll come only if you don't know how to swim".

Loud laughs.

62

EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1936 - DAY

62

One of the yellow notes is stuck on the eucalyptus tree. Yehudit passes it, carrying a basket of laundry, reads it, and walks away half-smiling. Moshe goes over and reads it as well: "Yehudit, how do you live in two places at once? Here and in my head?"

MOSHE

You're leaving it there?

YEHUDIT

It's your tree.

Yehudit keeps walking.

Moshe looks at the note. He takes it off and then, annoyed, he strides off. Yehudit watches him out of the corner of her eye.

63

OMISSIS

63

64

E/I. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1936 - SUNSET

64

In the warmth of sunset, Yehudit and Naomi are returning home, carrying bags of groceries. She studies the shadows they are casting.

NAOMI

Look how tall I am! When I'm as tall as this, I'll get married and you'll come live with me.

Yehudit bursts out laughing.

Cheerful, Yehudit and Naomi walk into the stable where Moshe is already milking the cows. He doesn't turn to look at them. Yehudit notices something is not right.

She looks around. Her smile vanishes, and she drops the shopping: **Rachel's spot is empty.**

YEHUDIT

(blunt)

Where is she?

Moshe doesn't say a word. He doesn't turn. As Naomi looks around, Yehudit contains her tears and her words.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

(to Naomi)

Don't worry. Go in the house.

Sad and upset, Naomi leaves.

Like a zombie, Yehudit takes a stool, sits near a cow, and starts milking. Her shaking fingers betray her emotions. Her eyes tear. Her teeth clench.

Moshe looks at her out of the corner of his eye, waiting for an avalanche of fury. But it never comes.

65 MONTAGE: I/E. MOSHE'S HOME/ROOM/STABLE/FARMYARD - 1936 - 65 NIGHT

The dead of night. Moshe stands by the window of his room. He looks out towards the stable: no movement except for the rain drumming down on the farmyard. He grabs a blanket and abruptly leaves the room.

CUT TO:

Using the blanket as protection from the rain, Moshe runs across the farmyard in the downpour. He opens the door of the stable: the curtain to her "room" is open, but **Yehudit isn't there.**

CUT TO:

Sad, Moshe goes back into his room and tries to sleep, but it is torture. He goes back to the window. The rain is coming down even harder.

CUT TO:

Moshe is finally sleeping. The **bang of the stable clapper wakes him up.** He runs to the window: **the stable door is now half-open.**

CUT TO:

Moshe throws the stable door open and goes in.

Rachel is back in her place. Yehudit is crouching next to the animal. They are both soaking wet, trembling and panting, vapor clouds puffing out of their mouths.

Yehudit does not even look at him, her eyes filled with resentment.

Moshe, overcome by rage, leaves.

CUT TO:

Moshe opens a tin hidden on top of the wardrobe in his room. Inside, there's a **wad of money**. He grabs it disappointed and even more furious.

CUT TO:

Moshe runs back across the farmyard, ignoring the rain and mud.

CUT TO:

Upset, Moshe storms back into the stable.

Yehudit has lit a small fire inside a barrel. She is rubbing Rachel's coat dry with sacks.

MOSHE

How did you get her back!?

YEHUDIT

(harsh, not looking at
him)

None of your business, Rabinovich.

MOSHE

(showing her the wad of
money)

The money Globerman gave me is
still here.

(raising his voice)

How did you pay him?

YEHUDIT

It didn't cost you a cent. And
don't raise your voice with me.

MOSHE

How? You stole her!

Moshe sounds like he almost hopes she has. But Yehudit's cruel cackle dispels any doubt. She stares at him for the first time in the eye, leaving no room for doubt. Moshe grabs her by the shoulders.

MOSHE (CONT'D)
How did you pay for her?!?

She glares at him. Out of control, he hurls the wad of money in her face.

MOSHE (CONT'D)
Whore!!!

Blinded by rage, **even Moshe is stunned he said such a word.**

As if he's pushed a forbidden button, Yehudit, calm and clear-headed, **grabs the pitchfork**, strides over to him and takes a **stab at him**, not touching him, but making him fall back into the cold manure.

Expressionless, Yehudit wields the tool again, and this time **she forks the outside of his arm**. She pulls the pitchfork out, and Moshe screams in pain. She's about to strike again, but the man rolls away and escapes, still screaming.

66 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - ROOM - 1936 - NIGHT

66

His wound now cleaned and bandaged, Moshe tosses and turns in a feverish sleep, his body trembling with spasms.

He's delirious. **His mind fills with caresses, whispers, delicious smells, and the muffled echo of a woman's voice.**

Yehudit's lips kiss the skin around the wound, his callous fingers, and his lips which quiver in shock and pleasure.

Their hands thread together. Their breathing deepens.

67 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1936 - DAWN

67

At dawn, the rain has stopped, and everything slowly drips. The gutters, the cart, the eucalyptus leaves.

68 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1936 - DAWN

68

Someone is knocking at the door. Yaakov, still in his pajamas, goes to open.

He has a start when he sees **Yehudit in front of him**, her hair down over her shoulders, giving him a hint of a smile.

The man almost faints in seeing such a vision.

ZAYDE (V.O.)
I came into this world as ransom
for a sterile cow...

69 I/E. INT. ZAYDE'S CAR/ROAD JERUSALEM HOTEL -1978- SUNSET 69

Inside the car, Zayde smirks while Esther doesn't say a word, stunned for a few seconds.

ESTHER

Wow. They were pretty emancipated, those pioneers... One woman and three men in the 1930's! And I thought I was a nonconformist!

Zadye looks at her, thinking.

ZAYDE

Actually people were much more open than you'd imagine... with solid principles, but not so much conditioned by morals and things like that...

ESTHER

Never would have thought it.

Zayde smiles. Esther changes her tone.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Why did your mother want to... muddy the waters?

Zadye frowns.

ZAYDE

What do you mean by "muddy the waters"?

ESTHER

Well, she didn't want anyone to know who the father was. I mean, if she got pregnant. i

She has struck a nerve. He gets on edge.

ZAYDE

She was anything but calculating... or an opportunist... She did what she had to...

Seeing his reaction, Esther tries to patch things up.

ESTHER

Hey, I wasn't judging her. Just the opposite.

Zayde is still irritated.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Forgive me, really...

Zayde relaxes a little.

ZAYDE
Ok, don't worry.

Esther smiles at him.

ESTHER
Okay, I'm gonna go, then. I am
interested in the house. You still
have to tell me the price.

ZAYDE
Ok, sure, I'll let you know.

They say goodbye awkwardly.
Esther gets out of the car and walks toward the hotel.

Zayde looks frustrated. He shakes his head, unsatisfied. He
gets out of the car and takes a few steps towards her.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
Sarah...!

Esther turns.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
... would you like to see Yaakov's
house?

Esther opens into a smile.

ESTHER
Yes, I would. Are you selling it,
too?

ZAYDE
I might think about it.

ESTHER
Well, I'm leaving in a few days,
so...

Zayde seems expansive and awkward at the same time.

ZAYDE
What are you doing tomorrow?

ESTHER
Tomorrow? That's good for me. In
the morning?

ZAYDE
In the morning... I have an
appointment but... I can move it.
Shall I pick you up at 10 o'clock?

ESTHER

Great.

They smile. Zayde walks back to his car.

ESTHER (O.S.) (CONT'D)

You have to finish telling me your story.

Zayde turns around happy, and she turns back towards the hotel.

70 E/I. ANTIQUE STORE - JERUSALEM 1978 - SUNSET

70

The shop window of an antique store in the Old Town is lit up, displaying jewelry and antiques. A MAN of around 70 stands behind the counter in the shop.

Through the shop window, Esther appears in the store. She takes off the pendant and shows it to the antiquarian.

He looks through the monocle and studies the pendant.

After a few seconds, he puts down the monocle and talks with Esther who appears disappointed with the man's explanations.

71 INT. HOTEL - LOBBY - BAR - 1978 - EVENING

71

When Esther stops by to pick up the keys, a female **HOTEL CLERK** (40) points something out to her in the lobby.

ARONSTAM (O.S.)

(excited)

... his name is Yosef Levin, he lives just outside Jerusalem.

CUT TO:

Esther and Aronstam are sitting at a table in the hotel bar. Esther smokes as she looks through some papers.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

He's the son of Yehudit Levin who died in 1966. He was born in Kyriat Sforim, a settlement in the North. In 1935.

The lawyer says the last phrase, staring at Esther, serious. She looks at him, taken aback.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

Yes, I think this must be the one. Everything coincides.

ESTHER

He has his mother's last name...

Aronstam nods, pleased.

ARONSTAM

You're learning the business...

ESTHER

(wry)

I've been practicing...

ARONSTAM

Well, no trace of a father. She could have been a single mother, that wasn't so unusual...

ESTHER

So I'm hearing.

72 INT. HOTEL - ROOM - 1978 - EVENING

72

Esther is sitting on the bed, breathing heavily. Then she shakes her head and with a bit of regret, grabs the phone receiver and dials a number written on a sheet of paper.

ESTHER

Hello, how are you?

73 INT. NAOMI'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - 1978 - EVENING

73

Zayde is on the phone. He looks very disappointed.

ESTHER (O.S.)

Unfortunately, I can't make it tomorrow morning. I have an appointment to see another house, and they can only show it to me tomorrow.

Naomi appears in the room and notices her brother's bad mood.

ZAYDE

Oh, I see. No problem. Yes, yes, of course, let me know then. Have a nice evening...

Zayde hangs up, disappointed. The sister speaks to him in Hebrew

NAOMI

The American woman?

Zayde mumbles something, distracted.

NAOMI (CONT'D)
What's the matter?

ZAYDE
(on edge)
Nothing, we were supposed to...
forget it. Don't always ask me
questions, Naomi.

Naomi doesn't have a chance to respond because Zayde goes off and locks himself in his room.

74 EXT. HOUSE - GARDEN - 1978 - DAY

74

In a lush, untended garden of a simply-designed villa, **JOSEPH LEVIN**, his 45 years weighing heavily on him, in coveralls is pruning an overgrown bush with garden shears.

A doorbell rings. The man heads to the gate, opens it and finds Esther wearing a simple, elegant dress, boots, and a leather jacket.

LEVIN
(cordial)
Welcome...

They shake hands and exchange pleasantries, but, guarded, he does not invite her to come in.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
As I told you on the phone, I don't believe I can help you... I was only nine years old when I left Kyriat Sforim...

ESTHER
Well, I was only three. But I think a child's memories would be really helpful for the book I have in mind.

Levin studies her for a few seconds, uncertain and calculating.

LEVIN
Fine, come in...

He leads her toward the house.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
We can sit inside. The owners are away. Would like a beer? Some coffee?

Esther declines with a shake of the head and keeps walking, glancing around.

75 INT. DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGY - HALLWAY/BATHROOM -1978- DAY 75

Zayde walks down the hallway and goes into the bathroom.

He starts to urinate.

Detail of his pee streaming into the toilet.

Drops of blood drip into the toilet: Zayde's nose is bleeding.

He calmly takes some toilet paper and holds it to his nose.

The flush of the toilet sucks everything away.

ESTHER (O.S.)

What do you remember from those years?

76 INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - 1978 - DAY

76

The house is bright and elegant in its simplicity. In the living room, Esther is sitting on the sofa, her legs crossed, a notebook in hand. Levin is sitting on a stool in front of her.

LEVIN

Like what?

ESTHER

Well, what did your family do? Were they farmers?

LEVIN

(abrupt)

I didn't have a family.

His tone takes her aback. He stands up, nervously.

LEVIN (CONT'D)

If you don't mind, I'm going to have myself a beer.

ESTHER

Sure, go ahead.

Esther looks around. She smooths out her dress to cover her legs a bit. Levin comes back from the kitchen holding the beer and sits next to Esther on the sofa.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Could you explain a bit more? What does it mean that you didn't have a family?

LEVIN

Little to explain.

He takes a long chug of beer.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
I grew up with my mother. She's
dead now. I didn't have a father.

ESTHER
And your mother... what did she do?

Levin stares at her and doesn't answer.

Uncomfortable, Esther takes out the pendant and the photo.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
Look, these belonged to my family.
Do they remind you of anything?

Levin ignores the pendant and takes a look at the photograph
without commenting.

LEVIN
What do you want from me?

Then he goes back to staring at her.

ESTHER
Like I told you...

Levin interrupts her.

LEVIN
If my mother created trouble with
your father, it's not my problem.
You're not the first or the last to
come and complain...

Esther's eyes widen.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
You're playing stupid? Everyone
knew. They kicked her out the
moshav when they caught her at it...
the very same ones who banged her
for years...
(raising his beer can)
Cheers to the dear moshavniks...

ESTHER
(stuttering)
I didn't know... I... I'm sorry...

LEVIN
(sarcastic)
Yeah, sure...

Levin touches her hair, allusively nodding to the other room.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
Let's go in there, so we can talk
about old times, what do you say?

Esther takes his hand away with a rapid and decisive gesture.

ESTHER
(nervous)
Mr. Levin, I better go...

He grabs her arm and yanks her back to the sofa, holding the back of her neck with his other hand, trying to pin her down and block her with his legs.

Esther tries to wrest free, screaming. He covers her mouth.

LEVIN
We could have some fun like they
used to...

She bites his hand and frees herself. He lets go.

LEVIN (CONT'D)
You whore...!!!

Esther runs out.

77 EXT. HOUSE - GARDEN- ROAD - 1978 - DAY

77

Upset, Esther sprints out of the house and heads for the gate.

ESTHER
Help! Help!

The man follows her, but he doesn't run.

LEVIN
Where are you going? What are you
screaming about? I didn't do
anything to you...

Esther opens the gate, agitated, and rushes out.

She does not stopping running even when she turns and sees that Levin is not chasing her.

78 INT. HOTEL - ROOM - 1978

78

Esther walks into the hotel room, crying. She leans against the door and lets herself slide down bringing her hands to her face.

ESTHER
What the fuck am I doing here? What
do I care about Israel?
(MORE)

ESTHER (CONT'D)

What do you want from me...? What the hell do I need to find out...? Why are you torturing me? Leave me alone...

CUT TO:

Esther is in the shower. She lets the water wash over her bowed head, her gaze lost, staring at the drain.

Blood appears in the water. She huffs.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Oh, shit. Now this...

CUT TO:

Curled up on bed in a bathrobe and towel around her head.

CUT TO:

Now she is dressed, her hair still wet. She throws her clothes into her suitcase without folding them.

ESTHER (O.S.) (CONT'D)

(hasty)

Could you see if there's a flight to San Francisco tomorrow?

79 INT. HOTEL - LOBBY 1978 - DAY

79

Still shaken, Esther wearing a leather jacket and with her bag in her hand is talking to the clerk at the front desk.

ESTHER

Any layover is fine.

The clerk takes note.

CLERK

Of course, Miss Horwitz, I'll check the schedule and let you know what's available.

Esther thanks her with a nod of her head and walks away.

80 INT. NAOMI'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - 1978 - DAY

80

While Zayde expertly cooks a dish with eggs, onions, tomatoes and peppers, he is listening to the radio.

SPEAKER V.O. (O.S.)

... and that's all for today, see you tomorrow...

As soon as he hears the notes of the song playing, Zayde freezes: it is **Heart of Gold**.

Lost in thought, he leans against the kitchen counter with his arms crossed.

ZAYDE
(in Hebrew)
Hello? Good evening... Would you
please put me through to Miss Sarah
Hedelman's room?

CUT TO:

Zayde listens, looking puzzled.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
Are you sure? Sarah Hedelman... Could
you check again, please?

He waits, his brow furrowed.

81 INT. BAR - 1978 - SUNSET

81

Esther is sitting alone at a table. Two empty glasses and a third full one are in front of her. Her gaze is lost in the void.

A MAN comes to sit at her table.

MAN
(in Hebrew)
Waiting for someone?

Esther slowly turns and stares at him, disoriented.

MAN (CONT'D)
(in English)
American? Tourist?

82 EXT. STREET - HOTEL JERUSALEM - 1978 - EVENING

82

Esther walks down the street, a bit tipsy. She stares down at the ground. When she looks up, she freezes, her eyes wide.

Zayde is parked in front of the hotel. As soon as he sees her, he comes out of the car, his expression grim.

Esther looks toward the hotel entrance and then back at Zayde, putting two and two together.

ESTHER
What are you doing here?

ZAYDE
Have you been drinking?

Esther shrugs and points at him, joking.

ESTHER
You're a smart guy...
congratulations!

She giggles. Zayde remains serious.

ZAYDE
I don't really feel like joking...
Who are you really?

Esther shakes her head, weary.

ESTHER
Forget it... I've had enough trouble
today. I'm leaving tomorrow and
I'll be done with Israel and this
whole thing.

ZAYDE
What thing? And what do I have to
do with it?

Esther looks down, tired and dejected.

ESTHER
I wanted to tell you yesterday,
when we said goodbye, but then I
thought I'd do it when...

She stops, dizzy. Zayde stares at her, stiff.

ESTHER (O.S.) (CONT'D)
My father probably had something to
do with that guy Levin's mother.
Who knows...

83 INT. ZAYDE'S CAR - 1978 - NIGHT

83

Zayde is driving through the countryside. The shadows stretch far. The colors are warm. Esther is curled up in her seat, wearing his jacket for warmth.

ESTHER
I don't even want to know at this
point. What's the use?

She breaks off. She has no more strength.

ZAYDE
I'm sorry...

A few seconds of silence. Then she turns to look at him.

ESTHER

Will you tell me the rest of your
story? Please?

Zayde smiles at her.

FADE TO:

84

EXT. FIELD - DAY/SUNSET 1937

84

Men, women and children are raking hay in a large field in the warm afternoon light. In the distance, on the horizon, the smoke from farmers burning other fields.

Naomi is helping Yehudit, her eyes focused on Yehudit's belly that is just beginning to show.

NAOMI

Who made you pregnant, Yehudit?

YEHUDIT

A nafka mina... What difference does
it make?

Frustrated, Naomi falls silent. Yehudit notices and tries to make amends.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

Me. I got myself pregnant, Noimele.

Naomi peers at her, only partially satisfied by the answer.

NAOMI

Is that why you've stopped
screaming in the middle of the
night?

Yehudit says nothing, but smiles as she keeps working.

GLOBERMAN (O.S.)

Listen, we can get into a cock
fight over this...

CUT TO:

Everyone is eating under the shade of the sheaves, piled up to be loaded on carts.

Moshe, Yaakov, and Globerman are sitting to the side having a tense discussion.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

... but we'll never know whose child
it is.

Yehudit, who is eating with Oded and Naomi nearby, has her back to them.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

So the way I see it, he's the son
of all three!

The silence/consent of the other two men. Yaakov intervenes,
polemical.

YAAKOV

Let's make something clear once and
for all. Yehudit may live with you
and work for you, but that doesn't
give you any more rights than us,
Rabinovich.

GLOBERMAN

Right. Every so often, you surprise
me, Yaakov. Well done!

MOSHE

So be it. But I don't want to see
you running around my house all
the time. Yehudit is there to work.

The other two men don't agree, but they don't object either.

YAAKOV

But my baby can't grow up
surrounded by cows...

Globerman shakes his head, his pride wounded.

GLOBERMAN

What's wrong with that? I was born
around cows and I turned out better
than both of you.

YEHUDIT (O.S.)

I'm not budging from the stable.

The three men turn towards the woman, silenced.

CUT TO:

At sunset, everyone is heading back home with their carts
filled with hay. Globerman drives one of the carts. The
others walk.

85

MONTAGE: I/E. MOSHE'S HOUSE/FARMYARD/STABLE - 1937 -
DAY/NIGHT

85

Scaffolding and a brick wall have popped up near the stable.

A happy march accompanies the three fathers and Oded as they
are hard at work.

Globerman brings the mortar in the wheelbarrow, Yaakov stacks the bricks, and Moshe nails in the planks.

CUT TO:

The **new stable** is finished. It stands behind the other one.

With Rachel always by her side, Yehudit, her belly now round, is transferring the cows from the old stable to the new one. Naomi enthusiastically collaborates whereas Oded follows them unenthusiastically.

CUT TO:

The three men are busy cleaning and painting the old stable. A wall has been built to create a bedroom. The stable now looks like a house.

CUT TO:

85 bis INT. MOSHE'S HOME/STABLE. EVENING

85 bis

In the evening twilight, Naomi appears with a bunch of flowers in a jar.

She takes a look around: there is no one there.

Surprised, Naomi walks towards the room they have created with the dividing wall. She opens the door. The jar falls out of her hands, spilling the water on the floor.

Yehudit is in full labour, crouching next to the bed in an animal-like position. She is shaken by the pain of a contraction and she is breathing with instinctive knowledge and awareness.

Naomi stares at her with wide eyes, concerned.

NAOMI

I'm gonna get help!

Yehudit looks at her with tender firmness.

YEHUDIT

(in a faint voice)

There's no need, Noimele. You can help me. Go get some other towels and sheets...

Naomi steps back without commenting or insisting, then she turns around and runs out of the room.

NAOMI

(in a broken voice)

Don't die on me...!

With a smile full of pain, Yehudit replies right away, loudly.

YEHUDIT

You don't die of this. If anything
you live more!

86

INT. MOSHE'S HOME/STABLE - 1937 - MORNING

86

The morning light glows in the white-washed room. Yehudit is in bed, the **BABY** nursing at her breast. Naomi is curled up beside them, excited and content.

Standing around the foot of the bed, Moshe, Yaakov, and Globerman stretch their necks to catch a glimpse of the little one's face. Proud, they brim with emotion.

Globerman breaks the ice with yet another rude comment.

GLOBERMAN

Who does he look like?

The others stare at Yehudit.

YEHUDIT

Me.

Globerman takes that in with a sly smile.

YAAKOV

Have you thought of a name? We... we
talked about it and...

YEHUDIT

(firm)

His name will be Zayde.

The three men look at one another, confused. Globerman comments, chuckling.

GLOBERMAN

Zayde?!? What kind of name is that
to give a baby?

Yehudit doesn't blink an eye.

YEHUDIT

If the Angel of Death comes and
finds a child named "Grandpa",
he'll believe he made a mistake.

Her argument leaves the three men speechless.

GLOBERMAN

So?

YEHUDIT

So, the Angel of Death won't take
the child. Obviously.

87 EXT. COUNTRYSIDE - 1945 - DAY

87

SUPER: BEIT CALEB, MARCH 1945

Zayde, now 8, is climbing a tree.

Below him, **THREE KIDS his age throw pebbles at him.**

KID 1

Where you running to, Grandpa?

KID 2

Call your daddy! You have three!

The kids burst out laughing.

Glum, Zayde climbs higher up to the top of the tree. Slowly,
the kids' laughter gets lost in the distance.

Zayde settles himself on a robust branch. He looks around.
Nearby, he glimpses a half-hidden nest. He watches it,
intrigued, then cautiously approaches it.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE (O.S.)

Everyone has only one father. Or
they don't have one at all.

88 EXT. VEGETABLE GARDEN/COUNTRYSIDE - 1945 - DAY

88

Yehudit is digging up potatoes in a field. Nearby, Moshe is
loading the cart with baskets full of vegetables. With
teary eyes and scratches all over, Zayde interrogates his
mother who turns to look at him without paying him too much
attention.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE (O.S.)

Why do I have to have three?!?

YEHUDIT

Having three fathers means you have
none, Zayde. You don't have a
father; you only have me.

For a moment, Moshe stops to look at the boy. Zayde scrunches
up his face and loses his patience.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE

Choose one! How hard can that be?
Why don't you care that everyone
teases me because of you?!? I don't
have any friends!

This time Yehudit stops working and answers her son, calm and firm.

YEHUDIT

You have your brother and sister.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE

Oded is fighting at the front in Europe, and Naomi is married!

Zayde thinks for a moment and then attacks.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE (CONT'D)

And if I don't have a father, that means I don't have a brother or a sister either!

The woman does not reply. Frustrated, Zayde stomps off.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE (CONT'D)

In any case, when I grow up, I'm going to change my name!

Yehudit goes back to grooming the horse.

YEHUDIT

One day you'll thank me...

Moshe stops working and calls the boy who is walking away.

MOSHE

Zayde! Come.

Zayde stops, he looks at him but does not move.

MOSHE (CONT'D)

Help me load.

Zayde approaches him and starts helping him. Yehudit follows them from the corner of her eye.

ESTHER (O.S.)

I can't believe it...

89

EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE/YARD. NIGHT 1978

89

Zayde's car, the Morris, is parked in front of the house. Zayde and Esther are still sitting in it, looking at the house in the twilight. The canary shed is in ruins. Weeds cover the farmyard; a solitary pole is erected in the middle.

ZAYDE

What?

ESTHER

That your name is really "grandpa".

(MORE)

ESTHER (CONT'D)

I mean, I think of your girlfriends saying, "I'm going out with 'grandpa' tonight"... that can't have been easy.

He laughs.

ZAYDE

Eventually I got used to it. And, in a way... I always kind of hope that it works!

90

INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - NIGHT

90

Insistent knocking at the door

Late at night. Yaakov, his beard not shaved, looking worse for wear, reaches the door stumbling.

YAAKOV

Hey, who... who is it?

He opens the door a crack and finds **a man of about 30 (SALVATORE)**, wearing blue coveralls. His dark complexion looks even darker in the blackness of night.

Frightened, Yaakov coils back and goes to shut the door.

SALVATORE

Please, let me in. I won't hurt you, I promise.

The man's clasped hands and gentle face convince Yaakov. Hesitant, he lets him in. Then he looks outside to make sure no one is out there and shuts the door.

CUT TO:

The man is now sitting at the table, devouring bread, cheese, and cucumbers. The living room and kitchen are a dirty mess.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)

My name is Salvatore. I'm from Naples... I was captured in El Alamein over two years ago.

Yaakov sighs, feigning interest.

YAAKOV

What camp did you come from?

SALVATORE

Ein Shemer...

YAAKOV

You've walked a long way.

Salvatore nods, his mouth full.

YAAKOV (CONT'D)
You speak our language well.

SALVATORE
I'm a fast learner.

Yaakov pours him some wine.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
(moved)
Thank you... I haven't had a glass of
wine since forever...

YAAKOV
(moved to pity)
You can stay here tonight. Then
tomorrow we'll see.

Salvatore raises his glass to him.

SALVATORE
War may have divided us, but I've
never liked Mussolini. Thank you so
much. I will pay you back.

YAAKOV
(with a bitter smile)
You'll pay me back, right...

Salvatore looks at him, concerned.

91 EXT. FIELDS - DAY

91

Globerman and Zayde are eating a sandwich taking in the
view from the top of a rocky cliff below which fields and
crops stretch out as far as the eye can see.

GLOBERMAN
As far as you can see... I know
every cow... believe me.

Zayde nods in awe. Globerman takes a small package out of
his jacket and hands it to him.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)
For you.

Zayde unwraps it, curious: it's a wallet from which Zayde
takes out two coins with a surprised expression.

ZAYDE
150 mils...

Globerman grins in satisfaction.

GLOBERMAN

Listen to me, son... You're a smart boy, and one day you'll do what I do. So remember: if you want to make money, put your heart into it. But if you want a woman's heart, use your head!

Zayde nods without really understanding.

ZAYDE

You're the richest man around here, right?

Globerman gloats, pleased.

GLOBERMAN

Well, I earned what I have, that's for sure. You know the saying, "If you have money in your pocket, you're handsome, smart... and a great singer, too!"

The two laugh and enjoy their sandwiches.

92 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - DAWN

92

Still rumpled and sleepy, Yaakov reaches the kitchen where a breakfast fit for a king awaits. His eyes widen as he looks at the table.

93 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - DAWN

93

Yaakov looks outside holding a steaming cup. He leans on the doorway of the porch and watches Salvatore demolishing crates that no longer can be used.

YAAKOV

You cook well.

SALVATORE

Well, I'm not too bad, I guess.

Yaakov studies him for a few seconds. Salvatore notices and keeps on working.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)

... I had a look around and... let's say that... there would be a lot of fixing up to do... the vegetable garden... the fields... not to mention the orange grove.

YAAKOV
(sarcastic)
What, you're also an agronomy
expert now?

Salvatore smiles while he keeps demolishing the crates.

SALVATORE
I've told you, I'm a fast learner,
and you wanna know why? Because I
observe others. I observe how they
do things. And this way I learn how
to do them myself.

Yaakov thinks it over.

YAAKOV
If I decide to let you stay... what
do I tell people?

Salvatore pauses, panting and sweating.

SALVATORE
That you got yourself an handyman.
From now on, my name is Yehoshua...
Salvatore! What do you say?

Yaakov stares at him, perplexed but tempted. Then he looks
over at Moshe's farmyard where Yehudit is hanging out the
laundry.

93bis INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1978 - EVENING

93bis

From the darkness inside, a door opens. Zayde walks in
holding a full bag of groceries and turns on the light.
Esther follows him, looking around.

It looks less like a farmhouse now; there's a TV and some
modern furniture. The house has clearly been lived in until
recently. Zayde moves around as if he were at home. He puts
some wood in the stove and starts to light it.

ZAYDE
Make yourself at home. The bathroom
is next to the bedroom. How's your
head?

Esther reassures him with a nod. She pauses to study the
portrait of a woman on the wall.

ESTHER
Who's this?

ZAYDE
Rivka. They say the portrait
doesn't do her justice... I'm going
to cook something, you hungry?

ESTHER

A little. Why did he keep her
portrait?

ZAYDE

I don't know... maybe so he wouldn't
forget what happened...
(changing the subject)
Want to give me a hand?

ESTHER

Sure. But I can't do much besides
fry an egg.

Zayde smiles.

94

INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - SHED - DAY

94

Yaakov and Zayde are giving birdseed to the canaries. Outside
in the yard, Salvatore is listening while sharpening the tip
of a wooden pole.

YAAKOV

I've built something for you!

The man grabs a wooden box with a slit on one side. Zayde
watches it curiously.

YAAKOV (CONT'D)

You can use it to get up close to
birds. Scatter some grains of
wheat on the ground, then you get
in there and wait for them to
come.

Enthusiastic, Zayde gets inside the box, helped by Yaakov.
His eyes appear inside the slit.

He adjusts it to watch the canaries.

8-YEAR-OLD ZAYDE

Mama says that animals should never
be kept in cages...

Yaakov shakes his head, confident.

YAAKOV

My canaries are happy...

Zayde looks at him, not all that convinced. Yaakov also looks
at the canaries and seems less convinced of his claim.

95

EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1945 - DAY

95

Yehudit is washing out the milk buckets in the trough.
Nearby, Zayde is playing with his box.

YAAKOV (O.S.)

Yehudit!

She looks up towards the direction of his voice: Yaakov is coming with his hand-drawn cart carrying four cages full of chirping canaries.

When Yaakov gets a few meters from her, he stops. Then, with one gesture, **he pulls a rope tied to all the gates on the cages**, opening them all at once.

The birds fly out in a cloud invading the yard.

YAAKOV (CONT'D)

Here, for you, Yehudit Solomon!

Yehudit can't help but look up, her mouth agape.

Hearing all the chirping, Moshe looks out from the stable, frowning, while Zayde comes out of his box and tries to catch the canaries.

Yehudit looks over to Yaakov.

YEHUDIT

Now you don't have any more canaries, Yaakov.

Yaakov's face lights up.

YAAKOV

This is the first time you've called me by my first name.

Yehudit replies bluntly.

YEHUDIT

That doesn't mean a thing...
(pointing at the canaries)
Same as all this. These are just your fantasies.

Yaakov stops smiling and turns melancholic. He puts his hat back on and walks head bowed towards his house where Salvatore who has witnessed the whole scene is bundling some kindling wood.

Yehudit goes back to washing the buckets. Moshe goes over to her, and speaks without looking at her.

MOSHE

Be gentle with him.

He turns and stares her in the eye: Yehudit stiffens, annoyed.

MOSHE (CONT'D)

If you go on like this, he'll kill himself.

She lifts up the tin buckets, clanging them, and walks off. She takes a few steps, turns and replies, glaring at him.

YEHUDIT

I don't think he will. And it isn't any of your business. I am just your hired help, nothing more.

Moshe, mortified, lowers his gaze.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

(wry)

My mother was right about this...
Yaakov didn't kill himself...

96

INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE. EVENING 1978

96

Zayde is cooking dinner. He is expertly chopping the parsley, as a sauce bubbles in the pot.

ZAYDE

He died last year... in the end, he outlived them all...

Esther watches, charmed, her arms crossed and her head tilted. He notices.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

Don't look at me...

(laughing)

Please don't look at me like that,
I get distracted...

Esther smiles and looks some place else and grabs the salt shaker. She is about to put some in the sauce.

ESTHER

May I?

Zayde nods, then he adds the parsley and stirs everything. He dips the tip of a spoon into the sauce, softly blows on it, and holds the spoon out to her.

Always staring into his eyes, Esther tastes it.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Mmmmm...

ZAYDE

Good? Let me taste...

Zayde becomes serious, he leans toward her and **brushes his lips against hers**. Esther opens up like a flower. They hold onto each other and kiss passionately.

ESTHER
Something's burning.

ZAYDE
Indeed.

ESTHER
The sauce.

Laughing, he quickly goes back to the stove.

CUT TO:

Esther and Zayde are eating at the table. Zayde pours some water into their glasses. He raises his to make a toast. Amused, Esther does the same with her glass of water.

ZAYDE
What about the stewardess story?

ESTHER
What about it?

ZAYDE
I mean... that one isn't made up...

Esther lets out a loud laugh. Then gesturing with a formal voice.

ESTHER
No, it's all true.
(clearing her voice)
Ladies and gentlemen, we'd like to direct your attention to some of the safety features of this aircraft...

ZAYDE
(joking)
Go easy on me, I might lose control...

Esther laughs again then becomes thoughtful.

ESTHER
You make me laugh. It's nice...

Esther takes another bite.

ESTHER (CONT'D)
This is so good... Where did you learn?

ZAYDE

To kiss?

Esther bursts out laughing again.

Then she stares at him and asks tentatively.

ESTHER

Listen, who was that woman at the university?

ZAYDE

Who... Ruth? She's a researcher. We went out a few times, nothing more.

Esther replies like she knows better.

ESTHER

Let me tell you something, she definitely thinks there's more.

ZAYDE

You think so?

ESTHER

I say so.

ZAYDE

Well, it's not mutual.
(beat)

And now, here we are, you and me.

They exchange a knowing look.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

How come your marriage ended?

Esther seems fragile.

ESTHER

My husband dumped me for a younger woman. They have two kids now.

ZAYDE

And you? Did you have kids?

ESTHER

No. I can't have children.

Zayde looks at her with a serious expression.

ZAYDE

And... did you want to?

The woman blushes, embarrassed.

ESTHER

Am I wrong, or was I the one
asking too many questions?

Touchè, Zayde apologises with a nod.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Well, let's just say it's something
I can't change...
(changing the subject))
So, how did you learn to cook?

Zayde gives her a mischievous look.

SALVATORE (V.O.)

You're lovesick over that woman,
aren't you?

97

INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE SUNSET/NIGHT 1945

97

An egg cracked on the edge of a bowl, then poured into
someone's hand separating the white and keeping the yolk.

Yaakov is playing with what is left of the food on his
plate.

Salvatore is busy cooking something on the stove, stirring
hectically with a whisk.

SALVATORE

The woman who works for your
neighbour.

Yaakov does not look at him, nervous.

YAAKOV

None of your business.

Unfazed and with the expression of someone who knows
better, Salvatore puts a bowl on the table while he keeps
on stirring.

SALVATORE

Taste this. You'll forget
everything for a few minutes...

He raises the whisk creating a waterfall of thick and
yellow cream. He smells it, inebriated. He pours the cream
in a bowl with the help of a spoon and offers it to Yaakov.
A little wary but attracted by the warm and sweet smell,
Yaakov tastes a spoonful. His eyes widen, then he looks at
Salvatore.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)

It's "zabaione"(in Italian). A
specialty from where I come from.

Yaakov cannot stop eating it. Salvatore giggles, pleased.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
Who's the woman in the portrait?

YAAKOV
She is Rivka... my wife, she left a long time ago...

SALVATORE
Oh well I don't blame her... you lost your mind for another woman...

Yaakov holds his breath, annoyed.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
And... the boy, the woman's son, is he the neighbour's son?

Yaakov shifts, annoyed.

YAAKOV
He is his son as much as mine.

Salvatore frowns, intrigued.

CUT TO:

It is late at night. Yaakov sits at the now cleared table, except for two glasses and an empty bottle of wine. Salvatore is standing and he is opening another bottle with the corkscrew.

SALVATORE
(thinking)
... a son and three fathers...

He uncorks the bottle.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
(emphatically)
I'm the person you need. I can help you win her over, I know how these things work.

YAAKOV
(shaking his head)
What do you know... I've tried everything. I did crazy things for her.

SALVATORE
Crazy things, exactly. No logic. Like that business about the canaries. Useless.

Salvatore jumps up and takes some ingredients from the pantry: two eggs, some sugar and sweet wine.

He lays them down in front of Yaakov who stares at them without understanding.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
What do you see in front of you?

YAAKOV
My last mils...

SALVATORE
Don't think about the money now,
tell me what you see.

YAAKOV
Eggs, sugar, sweet wine...

SALVATORE
Wrong. You are looking at an
unforgettable, unbeatable Italian
"zabaione"...

YAAKOV
I confirm. Unbeatable. What's
your point?

SALVATORE
Now, what if I had put these
ingredients in front of you
hoping that you would choose me
as your cook? These and not the
final result.

Yaakov looks at him, suspicious and intrigued.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)
You want her to be yours?

Yaakov replies determinedly, pointing his finger at him.

YAAKOV
It will happen sooner or later.

SALVATORE
No it won't, if you don't make
the right moves. You see,
everyone thinks that first you
have to fall in love, then when
you're sure the other loves you
bla bla bla... eventually you'll
get married. But this is an
illusion. (points at the
portrait) Look how your marriage
turned out, am I right or not?

Yaakov is perplexed. Salvatore launches his plan as if he were firing an unfailing arrow.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)

First of all you must have all
your ingredients ready...

YAAKOV

I'm not following...

SALVATORE

You have to plan your wedding. To
the last detail.

Yaakov looks at him widening his eyes then bursts out
laughing.

YAAKOV

Our wedding? You're crazy...

SALVATORE

Listen to me carefully. It's
science. Everything must be
planned: the music, dinner, the
dress, the party... because if
there's a wedding there will be a
bride.

Yaakov stares at him sideways without replying.

SALVATORE (CONT'D)

And besides, she has a son with too
many fathers and she needs a
husband. Trust me, she will be
yours, you have my word. You let me
stay until the war is over, and
once it's over, you'll get married.

Salvatore sounds so convincing that Yaakov is left staring,
dazed and speechless.

98

INT. VINEYARD. DAY

98

While Yehudit is stacking up the pruned branches, Zayde is
watching a sparrow from his box covered with branches.

GLOBERMAN (O.S.)

It really bothers me that a woman
like you is still working as
Rabinovich's servant girl.

Zadye slowly moves the box to "frame" his mother and
Globerman who is leaning against his truck not far from where
he stands.

YEHUDIT

I am nobody's servant girl.

GLOBERMAN

Oh yes, you are! And the boy is the son of a servant girl and of... no one.

Yehudit stops without turning around, annoyed.

YEHUDIT

What do you want, Globerman?

GLOBERMAN

To make you happy...

She turns, peering into his face.

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

I know you. And I know no one could tie you down. But I can give you a good life, like a real lady. A home, money, education for the boy. Above all, you'd have your freedom.

Yehudit is amused.

YEHUDIT

My freedom? At what price?

Globerman looks at her seriously.

GLOBERMAN

I've never met a woman like you. And I'm also the only one who gets you.

The woman giggles and gets back to work.

SALVATORE (O.S.)

You are unhappy because of a woman, aren't you?

99 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1978 - DAWN

99

Zayde is sleeping on the sofa. The sound of someone tinkering in the kitchen wakes him up.

ZAYDE

Hey... you awake already?

ESTHER

Sorry, I didn't mean to make noise... Is there any coffee?

Zayde gets up. He takes a jar of coffee from a cupboard and hands it to Esther. He strokes her cheek. Esther rests her head on his shoulder.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

How did you sleep on the sofa?

ZAYDE

Well, it was worse during military service.

He rubs his neck, joking. Esther smiles, a bit uneasy.

ESTHER

I'm sorry, this is kind of weird for me, but I used to jump in too fast. I don't want to rush things anymore.

ZAYDE

I understand...

Zayde raises her head delicately lifting her chin. He stares at her with a reassuring smile. Then he kisses her tenderly.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

What's your plan? Do you really want to leave now?

ESTHER

I don't know. I don't know anymore. But I sure don't want to see that man again.

Zayde nods thoughtful, then he insists.

ZAYDE

So you're just giving up?

Esther lights a cigarette.

ESTHER

What else can I do? The photograph doesn't mean anything to anyone. All I found out about the pendant is that it's Yemenite craftsmanship, just to make things more complicated...

Zayde's face lights up.

ZAYDE

Yemenite? Who told you?

ESTHER

An antique dealer in Jerusalem, why?

Zayde looks at his watch. Esther looks at him, questioning.

100

MONTAGE: I/E. YAAKOV'S HOUSE/FARMYARD - DAY/NIGHT

100

Standing, a bucket with the yellow notes in his hand, Yaakov watches the flickering fire in the stove, hesitating.

Salvatore nods, encouraging him. Yaakov tosses the notes in the stove, and they burst into flames.

DISSOLVE TO:

On the same stove, pots and pans smoke and crackle. Salvatore takes a wooden spoon with a bit of sauce from a pan and gives Yaakov a taste. Yaakov finds it delicious.

DISSOLVE TO:

A cart is parked in front of Yaakov's house. There are various tools in the cart. **A FARMER** and Salvatore finish loading the canary cages on it. The farmer hands money over to Yaakov.

DISSOLVE TO:

Yaakov and Salvatore hoist a branchless tree trunk up, planting it in a hole dug in the middle of the farmyard.

Hidden inside his box, Zayde watches them from a distance.

DISSOLVE TO:

The tree trunk is now anchored in the terrain with taut rope.

On the road, a small audience, including Globerman and Papish, has gathered to watch as Yaakov and Salvatore unfurl large pieces of colored fabric onto the framework.

One piece of fabric unfurls after another until it looks like a circus tent. The children, including Zayde, watch curiously.

Globerman shatters the poetic atmosphere with a joke.

GLOBERMAN

Maybe he's getting a party ready
for Rivka's return...

PAPISH

Shut your mouth! Don't even mention
Rivka's name! When she left, she
took all the beauty here with her!
She left us alone with nothing but
to wallow in the muck of our
ugliness!

Globerman and the others laugh.

CUT TO:

A large lightbulb sparks on inside the tent.

From outside, the effect receives admiring applause amongst the spectators: the illuminated tent looks like a giant lantern with the gigantic shadows of Yaakov cast on the cloth.

All the children, Zayde included are enchanted and excited. Moshe seems perplexed while Yehudit giggles.

Inside the tent, Salvatore turns on the gramophone. Yaakov is excited. A snappy, contagious swing plays. Salvatore invites Yaakov to dance. Yaakov, embarrassed, is wooden, but willing to learn. Salvatore, agile and comfortable, twirls him around, making Yaakov lose his balance. Yaakov stands back up, laughing happily like a child.

101 INT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - DAY 101

The headlines fill the front page of Hareetz: "The war is over!" Yaakov looks up from the newspaper and over at Salvatore.

SALVATORE
(to the point)
The time has come.

Yaakov's face lights up.

102 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1945 - DAY 102

Someone knocks on the door of the stable. Yehudit opens the door.

On the threshold she finds a box on the floor.

The woman looks up and spots Salvatore wearing his blue prisoner coveralls with a white sack over his shoulder, walking away along the same pathway that Rivka had taken.

103 EXT. EMPORIUM - 1945 - SUNSET 103

Under the incredulous gaze of a few farmers watch, Yaakov posts the announcement of his marriage to Yehudit Solomon on the bulletin board. It is scheduled for October 14, 1945.

Only Globerman, leaning on his truck, appears skeptical. He intercepts Yaakov as he walks off.

GLOBERMAN
Look, Sheinfeld, frankly I don't
know why I care about this. After
all, you and I want the same woman.
(MORE)

GLOBERMAN (CONT'D)

And the more you act like a
schmuck, the better it is for me.
But take my advice... You're going
too far.

Yaakov answers, confident and calm.

YAAKOV

With Yehudit, we are all acting
like schmucks...

GLOBERMAN

I agree. But this isn't about the
impression you make. You're a good-
looking man. You had the most
beautiful woman in the village, a
job... and you threw it all away for
a woman who won't even look at you.

Yaakov answers, steady and confident.

YAAKOV

Maybe... but what you don't
understand, Globerman, is that she
can't escape fate. Otherwise, why
would Salvatore, an Italian
prisoner... why would he appear at my
house in the middle of the night!
My house, not yours or
Rabinovich's!

Globerman's friendly tone disappears. His expression hardens.

GLOBERMAN

Let me see if I understood well...
You're telling me that Hitler... may
his name be cursed forever... started
this goddamn war so your Italian
butler could prepare the fucking
wedding of Yaakov Scheinfeld and
Madame Yehudit?!

Furious, Globerman gets in his truck and roars off. Yaakov
shakes his head and walks off, as the others watch perplexed.

104 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE - 1945 - EVENING

104

Alone in her house, Yehudit opens the box and takes out a
rustling wedding dress.

She holds the dress out in front of her, looking at herself
in the mirror, serious.

105 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - KITCHEN - 1945 - DAY

105

Early morning, Yehudit is putting breakfast on the table for Moshe -- bread, honey, and milk. They don't talk, nor look at each other. The only sounds are the clatter of plates, glasses and cutlery as she puts them away.

When Moshe starts eating, Yehudit breaks the silence, without looking at him.

YEHUDIT

What everyone is saying is true.
I'm going to marry Yaakov. This
means I will no longer work for
you. Zayde and I will no longer
live here.

Moshe tightens his jaw, but he keeps his comments to himself. He finishes his mouthful, swallowing with difficulty. Then he drinks down some milk and without saying a word, he leaves the house.

Frustrated, Yehudit stops and takes a deep breath.

106 E/I. BEZALEL ART SCHOOL - OFFICE - 1978 - DAY

106

A large building with stairs leading to the entrance and a plaque in English and Hebrew, "Bezalel Academy of Art and Design - Architecture Department. Hebrew University of Jerusalem".

ZAYDE (O.S.)

This is Esther... Tamar...

CUT TO:

The woman (TAMAR) at the door is in her forties. Short hair, a stylish but unconventional intellectual, isn't beautiful, but interesting. She looks at Zayde, then studies Esther.

TAMAR

Please, come in.
(in Hebrew to Zayde))
It's been a long time...

The two women shake hands, Zayde ignores the woman's zinger. Tamar nods for them to sit in front of her desk. The room is filled with books and posters about Middle Eastern art.

TAMAR (CONT'D)

May I see the pendant?

Esther hands it to her. Tamar studies it up close.

TAMAR (CONT'D)

Yes, yes, it's one of those...

ESTHER

One of those...?

TAMAR

I am an expert in Yemenite craft--

ESTHER

(cutting her short)

Zayde told me.

TAMAR

A while ago, I discovered that a Yemenite goldsmith made these pendants for newborns in Kfar Ezra during the '30s.

Esther is confused.

ESTHER

Kfar...?

TAMAR

Kfar Ezra, a settlement near Tel Aviv. See? Here's an initial from the Hebrew alphabet, a Resh. An "R". It's very stylized, but that's how he made them.

ESTHER

So this belongs to a baby born there on **October 4th, 1932?**

TAMAR

Whose name begins with "R". Exactly.

Esther looks at Tamar, then Zayde.

107 INT. STATE ARCHIVES - CONSULTATION ROOM - 1978 - DAY 107

In the same bright, large hall, Esther and Zayde are consulting the birth certificates in one of the binders. Esther looks frustrated.

ESTHER

I can't believe it. No one with that initial was born in Kfar Ezra on that day.

She keeps leafing through it, back and forth, when she notices something...

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Wait, one is missing.

ZAYDE

How can you tell?

Esther shows him two certificates.

ESTHER

Look at the registration numbers.
This one is certificate 149 from
October, 1932, and this certificate
is 151. Number 150 is missing, see?

Her brow furrows, looking at Zayde. **A glimmer of light in her eyes...**

ESTHER (CONT'D)

How far is Kfar Ezra?

ZAYDE

Nothing is far in Israel.

108 INT. KFAR EZRA - MUSEUM - 1978 - DAY

108

Esther and Zayde are talking to an **EMPLOYEE** (40) with a receding hairline. He holds the pendant.

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA (O.S.)

It's difficult to trace the owner...

In the place, inside display cases, menorahs, photographs, and other treasures of the community.

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA (CONT'D)

Many people left, and all the
documents from the time of the
Mandate were brought...

ESTHER

(frustrated)

... To the central archives, I know,
but I didn't find anything there,
and...

The employee nods, thinking. Esther takes out the ripped photograph.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Does this tell you anything?

The man looks at it then nods.

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA

It was taken here for sure.

Esther and Zayde exchange a surprised look.

ESTHER

Really? Are you sure? That's me.
I was born in Haifa.

The man interrupts her, categorically.

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA

You see the ear of wheat drawn on
the water tower? It's
unmistakable. The tower was
demolished in 1948. This is not
Haifa, no way. It's Kfar Ezra.

Esther runs a hand through her hair, confused.

Zayde presses the employee.

ZAYDE

Who could have taken that
picture? Were there photographers
in the settlements?

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA

Oh yes, old Amos, the school
teacher. He had the passion for
photography. He mainly took
pictures of the settlers... many of
the photos you see here are his...

The man points at old photographs on the walls.

ESTHER

Is he still alive?

EMPLOYEE KFAR EZRA

I think so, but he moved a few
years ago. I don't know where he
is now.

Esther and Zayde exchange a knowing look. Esther turns to
the employee.

ESTHER

Can I make a phone call?

109

EXT. KFAR EZRA - COMMUNITY OFFICE - 1978 - DAY

109

Esther is on the telephone of the office, speaking
animatedly.

ESTHER

... you need to find a man named Amos
Shaff who lived in Kfar Ezra until
a few years ago.

ARONSTAM (O.S.)

I'll make a couple of phone calls
and get back to you. What did you
find, who is this person?

ESTHER

I think this is it, the last
missing piece... I'll explain
everything later, call me as soon
as you find something.

110 MONTAGE: I/E./ MOSHE'S HOME - STABLE -YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 110
FARMYARD 1945 - DAY

Yehudit is combing her wet hair. Zayde, is doing his homework
and has his back to her.

YEHUDIT

I am marrying Yaakov today.

Zayde turns to stare into her eyes and does not reply.

CUT TO:

White tablecloths unfurled in the wind one after the other
to cover a long table.

CUT TO:

YEHUDIT (O.S.) (CONT'D)

From now on, he will be your
father. Only him.

Over white, plates, glasses, and flowers appear. Then trays
filled with delicacies and pitchers of wine.

CUT TO:

Zayde still stares at her without saying a word.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

We will go live with him.

CUT TO:

A chuppah, the wedding canopy, stands in the middle of the
farmyard where a folksy string trio starts playing.

CUT TO:

Zayde turns his back to his mother. He scrunches his lips
together, trying not cry.

CUT TO:

Yaakov runs around, frenetically checking on all the details. The first guests start to arrive.

111 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - DAY 111

The entire settlement has been invited to the wedding. Globerman and Papish raise their glasses and mingle with the others.

A diminutive **RABBI** (70) with a yarmulke on his head and tallit over his shoulders, is stuffing himself with delicacies. As he sees Yaakov go by, he calls to him.

RABBI

When is the bride coming?

Yaakov answers with a confident, yet impatient smile.

YAAKOV

She's coming, she's coming..

The little man stares at him and comments sarcastically.

RABBI

Well, we've been waiting a long time... I mean, this is a bride, not the Messiah...

YAAKOV

For me, this bride is the Messiah!

The rabbi glares at him, shocked. He is about to say something, but Yaakov pours the rabbi more to drink to calm him down.

112 INT. MOSHE'S HOME - KITCHEN -1945- DAY 112

The noise from the party is replaced by the silence in the kitchen where Moshe is sitting alone in the kitchen. He appears defeated.

A glimmer makes him look up. Out the window, he glimpses **Yehudit in the wedding dress** as she is leaving the stable walking a few steps behind Zayde.

Moshe is frozen by her image, so beautiful and therefore so painful. He looks away. Then he glances back.

Yehudit's steps are slow and careful. Her face austere and inexpressive.

She glances toward the house where Moshe is, but their eyes don't meet.

So, she continues toward the road. The wind suddenly lifts Yehudit's veil. She holds it down with one hand. Her other hand holds a bouquet of wild flowers.

Moshe doesn't miss a detail: her slow steps, her glance toward the house, the wind that seems to be pushing her in the opposite direction, the eucalyptus leaves that bend towards her, reaching.

He looks as if he might explode.

113 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1945 - DAY 113

Yehudit is about to leave their farmyard.

MOSHE (O.S.)
Yehudit! Yehudit!

His shouts stop her. Her eyes widen. Then she closes them, takes a deep breath, and turns around. Moshe is only a few steps from her.

Zayde turns around to watch them.

They seem bound by an invisible thread with Yehudit in the middle.

114 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - 1945 - DAY 114

At the reception, the men have rolled up their sleeves, and the women have taken their shoes off under the tables. Everyone is quite relaxed from the waiting and the wine. A few people dance.

Yaakov is still impatiently wandering among the guests, glancing nervously towards the road.

115 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1945 - DAY 115

Moshe and Yehudit are still staring into each other's eyes.

MOSHE
Why are you doing it?

Yehudit doesn't blink an eye.

MOSHE (CONT'D)
Why are you marrying him?

YEHUDIT
You've found your tongue, Moshe?

Moshe searches for the words, but he can't find them. Then he blurts it out in a hushed voice.

MOSHE

If you don't love him, don't go,
Yehudit. Stay. Stay here... with me.

As if she has been waiting for these words forever, Yehudit starts to well up with tears. Tears of rage and tenderness.

YEHUDIT

Why... why did you wait so long?

MOSHE

So I wouldn't lose you.

Yehudit is caught by surprise. She doesn't understand.

YEHUDIT

You have a strange way of keeping
people near you, Moshe.

She turns and starts to go. Moshe speaks, this time determined. Yehudit stops, but does not turn.

MOSHE

For years, I tortured myself with
the thought that I hadn't saved
Tonia's life... And I told myself...
(lowering his head)
I would never love anyone else.

Yehudit listens, her expression enigmatic, absorbed in thought.

MOSHE (CONT'D)

Then you came... and you overturned
everything... I didn't know what to
do anymore. I decided that it
should be enough for me to have you
here. But now... seeing you go... you
and Zayde...

Yehudit is struck, but she responds with humor.

YEHUDIT

You have never said this many words
to me in all these years...

Moshe smiles. She struggles to contain her tears. She searches for words, fishing for them in the whirlwind of emotions.

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

Moshe... you put the curtain up for
me... you let me scream night after
night... you made a path...

(beat)

You did things the way they should
be done.

(MORE)

YEHUDIT (CONT'D)

(thinking)

Except when you sold Rachel.

They both start laughing and their tears mix with smiles. Yehudit can't hold back any more and **she throws herself into his arms, letting the veil fly away and her tears flow.** Moshe holds her, lifting her up in his embrace.

Zayde can't believe it. He's happy.

The veil flies away in the wind.

116 EXT. YAAKOV'S HOUSE - FARMYARD - DAY 116

Yaakov has come out onto the road, his back towards the reception. He sees **the wedding veil fly off in the distance.** Floating farther and farther away.

Every hope dies in his eyes. They cloud over with bitterness and disappointment.

117 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1945 - DAY 117

Yehudit's smiling face. Moshe faces her, gazing at her, happy.

They are under a white chuppah canopy that casts a radiant light on them. Yehudit is wearing a simple, light-colored flowered dress and a crown of daisies and freesia in her hair. He wears a white shirt and a *tallit* over her shoulders.

The same rabbi seen in Yaakov's farmyard is facing them, finally celebrating a wedding.

Spread out in a circle behind them, a small group of people including Globerman, Papish, and Zayde, beaming.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

They spent their honeymoon at the
seaside...

118 E/I. ZAYDE'S CAR/DESERT. DAY 1978 118

Seen from above, Zayde's car is a black dot driving along a tarmac road across an endless desert.

Epic music accompanies Zayde's and Esther's trip towards an unknown destination.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

Then, one night, a terrible wind
came, we'd never seen anything like
it before. It looked like the
settlement was going to be swept
away.

We start hearing the sound of strong wind..

118 bis EXT. SETTLEMENT - NIGHT

118 bis

A window slamming in the wind.

The eucalyptus' branches shaken by the strong wind.

The propeller blades spinning wildly.

The lightbulb at the entrance of Moshe's house swings under the heavy wind.

ZAYDE (O.S.)

After a few hours everything went
quiet and in the morning..

119 I/E. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - DAWN 1945

119

Wrapped in a wool shawl Yehudit comes out of the stable.

The farmyard is covered in snow same as all the surrounding landscape: **it snowed heavily** and everything is engulfed in silence.

Yehudit crosses the farmyard, leaving a trail of footprints behind her. As she walks, she turns to look at them, amused.

A sudden creak breaks the silence. A large branch on the eucalyptus tree weighed down by the snow is bending, breaking off the trunk. Yehudit is about to walk under it, but she doesn't realize it because, turned around, her deaf ear faces the tree.

CUT TO:

From the window, as Moshe is heating up the coffee, he notices the branch about to crash down on her.

He runs outside, shouting, distraught.

MOSHE

Yehudit!!!

Yehudit does not turn.

Moshe's distraught face as he shouts again.

Off screen: a violent thud.

120 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - DAY

120

The massive branch moves out of the shot, revealing Yehudit's corpse.

Globerman, Yaakov and the other moshavniks stand staring at her sprawled body lying in the red-stained snow. Yaakov kneels down next to her corpse, his head in his hands.

Zayde in pajamas watches everything, shaking in shock.

At that moment, **Moshe comes out of the stable, holding an ax.**

He starts to chop down the tree with superhuman strength, sweating, crying, and screaming in grief.

121 INT. ZAYDE'S CAR - DESERT - 1978 - DAY

121

... the sounds of the ax fade as we cut to Esther staring at Zayde inside the car. She is moved.

ESTHER

That's a beautiful love story. Very sad, though.

ZAYDE

Yeah... my sister Naomi says I never got over it. In a way, I think she's right.

Zayde turns and smiles at her. Then he points out a spot in the distance in front of them.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)

We're almost there. That sort of oasis there... that's Ein Yohsèf.

Esther attentively looks ahead of her.

ESTHER

Looks like the end of the world. Or the beginning...

122 EXT. EIN YOHSEF - AMOS' HOUSE - 1978 - DAY

122

Zayde and Esther approach a house along the road surrounding the settlement that looks out on the desert. The house is squat and square with a small garden of succulent plants. Zayde moves ahead, until they reach the front door which is open.

ZAYDE

Is anyone home? Amos Shaff?

AMOS (75), with kind eyes and features from a different era, comes out of the house wiping his hands off on a dish rag.

AMOS

Hello. I'm Amos, what would you like?

ZAYDE

Hello, I'm Zayde Rabinovich.
She's...

Esther moves forward smiling, she speaks in English.

ESTHER

Hello, I'm Esther Horwitz. I come
from the United States and...

She shows the old man the torn photograph. The man stares at
it suddenly emotional. Then he lightly shakes his head. His
eyes start filling up with tears.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

That's my dad in the picture, and
the baby... is supposedly me. They
told us you might have taken it.

AMOS

(interrupting)
You're Rachel.

The sentence is like a slap in the face to her.

ESTHER

Rachel...? No, my name is Esther.

Amos speaks in a sweet voice.

AMOS

Your eyes... they haven't changed.

Frowning, Esther shakes her head.

AMOS (CONT'D)

You're Rachel. Daughter of Shimon
Horwitz. And Yehudit Solomon.

Esther brings her hand to her mouth, frozen. She looks at
Zayde, her eyes wide. He is in shock, then recovers and
speaks in a sharp tone.

ZAYDE

(in Hebrew)
What are you talking about?

123

INT. KFAR EZRA HOUSE - 1932 - DAY

123

SUPER: KFAR EZRA, 1932

A woman's hands are rinsing lentils on a table.

AMOS (O.S.)

Shimon and Yehudit met as soon as
they got here in 1930. He was
Russian and she was Romanian.

(MORE)

AMOS (O.S.) (CONT'D)

They got married and went to live
in Kfar Ezra.

The hands are Yehudit's. She is sitting with a baby (**NEWBORN RACHEL**), asleep in her arms.

AMOS (O.S.) (CONT'D)

You were born soon after, but your
father just couldn't get used to
the life here... he'd been an officer
in the army, and the hardships in
the settlements were not for him.

In the bed in the back of the small, unadorned spartan room,
SHIMON is stretched out smoking a cigarette, frowning.

YEHUDIT

(not looking at him)

I know they're looking for
bricklayers in Tel Aviv...

Without looking at her, the man snuffs out his cigarette,
gets up from the bed.

SHIMON

I'm not going to be anyone's slave.
I'm going to find work in America.
I've already got my ticket.

Yehudit looks at him, stunned and worried.

YEHUDIT

In America?

SHIMON

Everything is different there. Six
months at most, time to set things
up, and I'll be back to get you.

Yehudit is taken aback.

YEHUDIT

Why didn't you tell me about this?
Shimon, I beg you, don't go...

Shimon pays no attention to her. He takes his hat and leaves
the house.

AMOS (O.S.)

He left for America a few days
later.

Dumbfounded, Zayde and Esther hang off every word Amos says
in the spartan living room.

AMOS

A year went by, then another... but
no news from him. Not a letter, not
a telegram. No one thought he'd
come back.

125 EXT. ORCHARD. 1934 - DAY

125

Yehudit chases young Rachel (**TWO-YEAR-OLD RACHEL**) amongst
the pomegranate trees of an orchard. The little girl is
wearing the necklace with the pendant.

AMOS (V.O.)

Yehudit was an extraordinary woman,
but being alone was hard for her. I
tried to help her, to be there for
her... and you.

The men and women who are picking the fruit smile when they
see them. Amongst them, a man in his 30s (**YOUNG AMOS**), with
a radiant and genuine face.

AMOS (V.O.)

I fell in love with your mother
immediately... and with time, Yehudit
also began to care for me...

CUT TO:

Yehudit with her daughter on her lap is sitting at the edge
of the orchard. The woman is feeding the pomegranate seeds to
her little girl who eats them voraciously.

YOUNG AMOS (O.S.)

Look this way. Both of you.

With a folding camera, Amos takes a picture of them smiling.

YOUNG AMOS (CONT'D)

Rachel! Hey, over here!

YEHUDIT

(laughing)

She's too focused on the
pomegranate.

Yehudit and him share a sincere and affectionate look.

126 I/E. HOUSE KFAR EZRA - 1934 - DAY

126

Rachel is asleep on the bed.

CUT TO:

Amos and Yehudit are sitting on the step outside the front
door, hugging.

They are reading an article in the paper and they look concerned: "The Reich has stripped German Jews of their citizenship."

AMOS (O.S.)
We wanted to build a family
together... then one day, while I was
away... everything changed...

127 INT. HOUSE KFAR EZRA - 1935 - DAY

127

SUPER: KFAR EZRA, 1935

Yehudit is again rinsing lentils, while Rachel beside her is making a mess of everything.

The front door opens, and Shimon walks in, looking like a new man: dressed American style with a Borsalino hat and a starched shirt.

Yehudit's eyes open wide, disbelieving and frightened.

The little girl looks at him without knowing who he is.

He opens his arms to show himself off.

SHIMON
I'm back!

The girl runs to hide behind Yehudit, **revealing her mother's prominent pregnant belly.**

In just a matter of seconds, Shimon goes from happy to furious. He moves to her and yells:

SHIMON (CONT'D)
You whore!

Rachel starts to cry.

He punches Yehudit on her right ear, hurling her to the floor. She screams, trying to shield herself from Shimon's kicks.

Rachel is frozen. **Shimon grabs the little girl who makes no resistance and lets herself be dragged away like a zombie.** Shimon turns at the door, takes a photograph from the inside pocket of his jacket, **rips it and throws half towards Yehudit.** He leaves slamming the door.

Yehudit lies on the floor in pain. She brings one hand to her bloody ear, while the other holds her belly, as she screams in despair.

YEHUDIT
Rachel! Rachel!!!!!!

128 INT. AMOS' HOUSE - 1978 - DAY

128

The scream still echoes as tears stream down Esther's face.

Esther hides her face in her hands. Zayde's eyes are red as he stares in front of him.

Amos visibly drained from the memory concludes in a hushed voice.

AMOS

From that moment, Yehudit closed herself off. She became harsh, even with me. The baby was born soon after... stillborn. She decided to leave, all she said to me was never to look for her...

Amos looks down shaking his head, his voice broken with emotion.

AMOS (CONT'D)

I guess that... I have never forgiven myself... for not being there when it happened.

Amos clears his voice, then looks at Esther.

AMOS (CONT'D)

It's a miracle that you've come all this way.

(to Zayde)

And I'm happy Yehudit had another son, what a blessing for her... even though she left us so young.

Esther turns toward Zayde, who is also moved, and smiles at him with tears in her eyes.

Amos stands up, goes to a cupboard, and rummages in a drawer.

He comes back to the table with the other half of the photograph where Yehudit is smiling.

AMOS (CONT'D)

This belongs to you...

He hands it to Esther who joins the two halves to make a whole.

129 EXT. AMOS' HOUSE - 1978 - DAY

129

Zayde and Esther walk out of Amos' house, shaken. From a car parked on the other side of the street, Aronstam gets out.

ESTHER

What are you doing here?

ARONSTAM

Did you find her?

Esther nods. Aronstam is surprised and impressed.

ARONSTAM (CONT'D)

I'm so glad... You'll tell me all about it I hope...

ESTHER

Yes, of course. Thank you, thank you for everything...

Aronstam takes a sealed letter out of his pocket and hands it to her.

ARONSTAM

I'm here because I had to give it to you if you succeeded in finding her. Directly... or indirectly.

Esther takes the letter. Lost, she looks at Zayde who nods for her to open it.

She takes a deep breath, then a few steps away into the deserted street as Zayde watches, supportive.

Esther opens the envelope. Inside there is a handwritten letter.

LEAH (V.O)

Dear Etty, Now that you know the truth, a truth that not even I know in full, please forgive me for never telling you I wasn't your mother.

Esther stops reading for a moment. Tears start streaming down her cheeks again. She looks at the desert in front of her.

LEAH (V.O) (CONT'D)

I was twenty years old. I had lost my parents, and I was about to undertake a long trip alone towards an unknown land. At the port of Haifa, I met your father, who had with him a beautiful little girl, sad and scared. You. Shimon told me that your mother was no good, that she was pregnant with another man's child and she didn't want to come with him to America. I believed him. He convinced me to declare that I was your mother. I said yes because I thought it was for your good, but it tormented me with doubt all my life.

Esther looks away from the letter. Her face betrays the whirlwind of emotions inside.

LEAH (V.O) (CONT'D)

Your father wouldn't tell me anything else, neither where you were born, nor your mother's last name. I could have no peace because of the thought that maybe he lied about this woman. If he did, don't blame him too much. He did what he could and that wasn't always the best thing, just like me.

Esther closes her eyes, then goes back to reading.

LEAH (V.O) (CONT'D)

I never found the courage to tell you. I was afraid of losing you, but I also wanted to protect you. I believed it was important for you to go on this journey and make this discovery, wherever it may have taken you. It was your right. I was sure you would find the answers because you are an extraordinary woman. I hope this story allows you to make peace with many things. I've loved you as if you were my own daughter. For me, you always have been. Forgive me if you can. Your Mom.

Facing the desert, Esther crouches down and hides her head in her arms. Zayde reaches her and squats down next to her, putting his hand on her shoulder.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL (V.O.)

It's a fairly common type of leukemia.

130 INT. DR. SANDOVAL'S OFFICE - 1978 - DAY

130

This time it's Esther sitting in front of the doctor at his desk now. Sandoval speaks in a serious and determined tone.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL

During the early years, there are few symptoms. Then it evolves into an intermediate, aggravated state. At that point, there's only so much we can do...

The doctor's gesture says everything. Esther listens, attentive.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL (CONT'D)

Let's just say your brother is entering this phase. So far, he hasn't been very cooperative with the treatments.

Esther gently interrupts him.

ESTHER

But now you have his biological sister.

DOCTOR SANDOVAL

Yes, but I must inform you that you will have to undergo a whole process before the transplant. And it's not without risks.

ESTHER

(firm)

I've made up my mind. I think I've done much riskier things in my life, and they weren't even for a good cause.

Dr. Sandoval looks at her, impressed, and nods.

131 INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - 1978 - DAY

131

Zayde and Esther, both wearing hospital gowns, are sitting on wheelchairs in a hospital room, both on IVs. Esther is wearing the pendant.

ZAYDE

You still have time.

ESTHER

I think we've talked this through enough.

Zayde nods.

ZAYDE

Are you scared?

She gestures that it's nothing.

ESTHER

You?

ZAYDE

A man called "Grandpa"...

Esther shakes his head.

ESTHER

You dope...

Zayde giggles.

ZAYDE
You know, I was thinking that I
owe you my life for the second
time...

Esther looks at him questioningly.

ESTHER
Oh, yeah... the first time, because
I left.

Zayde nods. Then finishes off her sentence.

ZAYDE
And the second time, because you
came back.

They smile at each other. Zayde changes tone.

ZAYDE (CONT'D)
There's just one thing...

ESTHER
What?

ZAYDE
(wry)
I still haven't figured out what to
call you...

Esther bursts out laughing, and so does her brother.

The door opens. A **NURSE** enters.

NURSE
Well... are you ready?

Zayde and Esther both nod at the same time.

FADE TO:

132 EXT. MOSHE'S HOME - FARMYARD - 1945 - DAY

132

We're back in the farmyard covered with snow.

Moshe runs out of the house, screaming desperately.

MOSHE
Yehudit!!!

But this time, hearing Moshe's scream, she turns straight to
him, avoiding the branch that a moment later crashes down in
front of her.

She looks at the branch, then looks up and smiles.

THE END